

HYPERPECTRAL & POLARIZATION IMAGING

Computational Imaging – Spring 2024

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Previously on **COMPUTATIONAL IMAGING**

Plenoptic imaging

- ✓ Basis:
- ✓ Digital photography (Lecture #1)
- ✓ Mathematical foundations (Lecture #2)

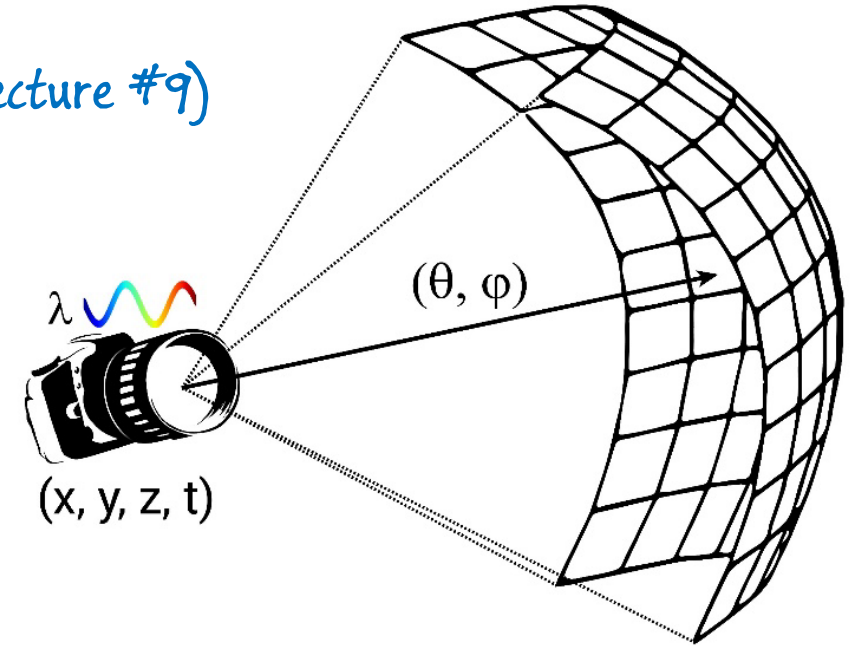
Transient imaging (Lecture #9)

Hyperspectral imaging (Lecture #8)

$$P = P(\theta, \phi, \lambda, t, x, y, z)$$

✓ Light field imaging (Lecture #4)

- ✓ High dynamic range imaging (Lecture #5)
- ✓ Computational displays (Lecture #6)



- Plus common tools and techniques:
- ✓ Coded photography (Lecture #3)
- ✓ Compressive sensing (Lecture #3)
- ✓ Computational illumination (Lecture #7)

What is an image?

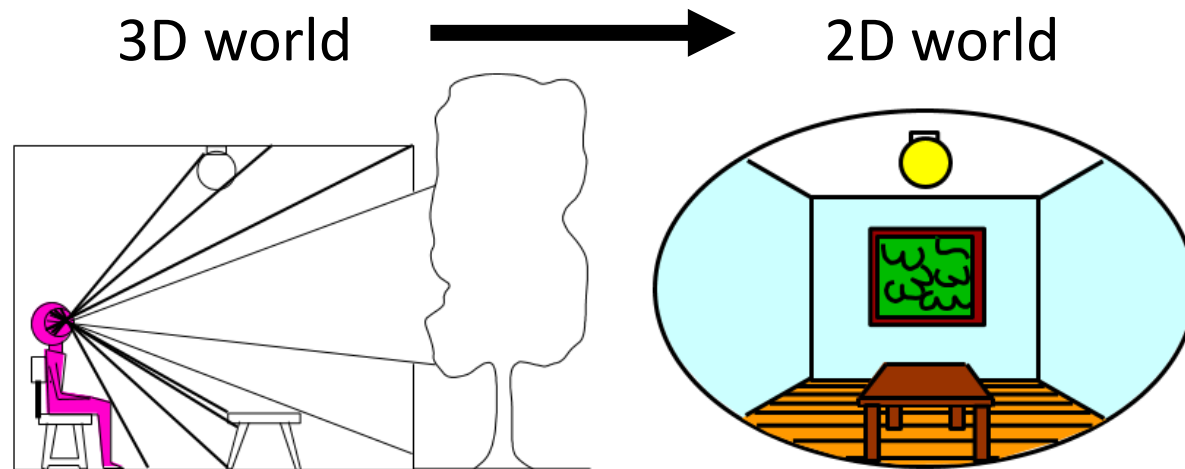
An image is a 2D realization of a 3D world:



View from the Window at Le Gras (1826)

What is an image?

An image is a 2D realization of a 3D world:



What do we lose?



View from the Window at Le Gras (1826)

What is an image?

An image is a 2D realization of a 3D world:

- Usually *depicts* visual perception ***
- Usually *simplifies* the physical world ***
- Usually *represents* visible light, color ***

But not always!



View from the Window at Le Gras (1826)

What is an image?

Mathematically speaking:

$$I : \mathbb{R}^2 \mapsto \text{color}$$

How do we generate I from a 3D world?

- Eye? Camera? Other device?
- How much definition? How “wide” can we see?

How do we capture and encode color?

- Digitally? Analogically? Human eye?
- B/W images: Single color value (i.e. intensity)?
- Color values: Tristimuli? More accurate? Intensity range?



View from the Window at Le Gras (1826)

LIGHT 101

What is light?

- Arguably, one of the greatest philosophical questions of all time.
 - Empedocles (s. V b.C.), Plato (s.IV b.C.), Aristotle (s.IV b.C.)
 - *Internal emitted fire connected with the eye* **(Emission hypothesis)**
 - Lucretius (s. I b.C.) –Newton (s. XVII-XVIII a.D.)
 - *Little particles traveling very, very fast* **(Particle hypothesis)**
 - Descartes, Huygens, Fresnel, Young (s. XVII)
 - *A wave propagating through the ether* **(Wave hypothesis)**
 - Gauss, Faraday, Maxwell (s.XVIII-XIX)
 - *An electromagnetic wave* **(EM hypothesis)**
 - Plank et al. (s.XIX-XX)
 - *A quantized electromagnetic wave* **(Quantum hypothesis)**

What is light?

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{D} = \rho$$

$$\nabla \cdot \mathbf{B} = 0$$

$$\nabla \times \mathbf{E} = -\frac{\partial \mathbf{B}}{\partial t}$$

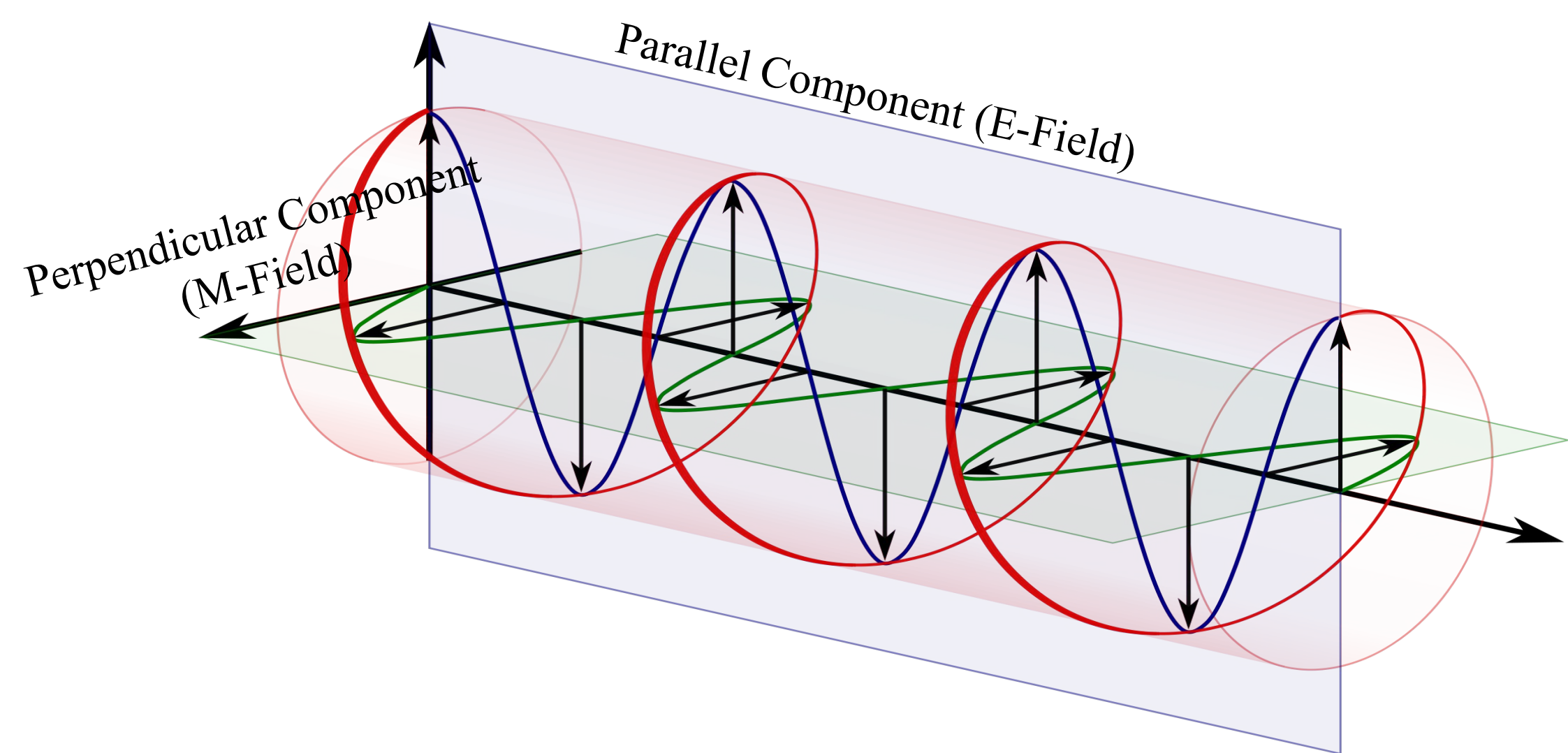
$$\nabla \times \mathbf{H} = \mathbf{J} + \frac{\partial \mathbf{D}}{\partial t}$$

And assuming a time-harmonic
monochromatic planar field

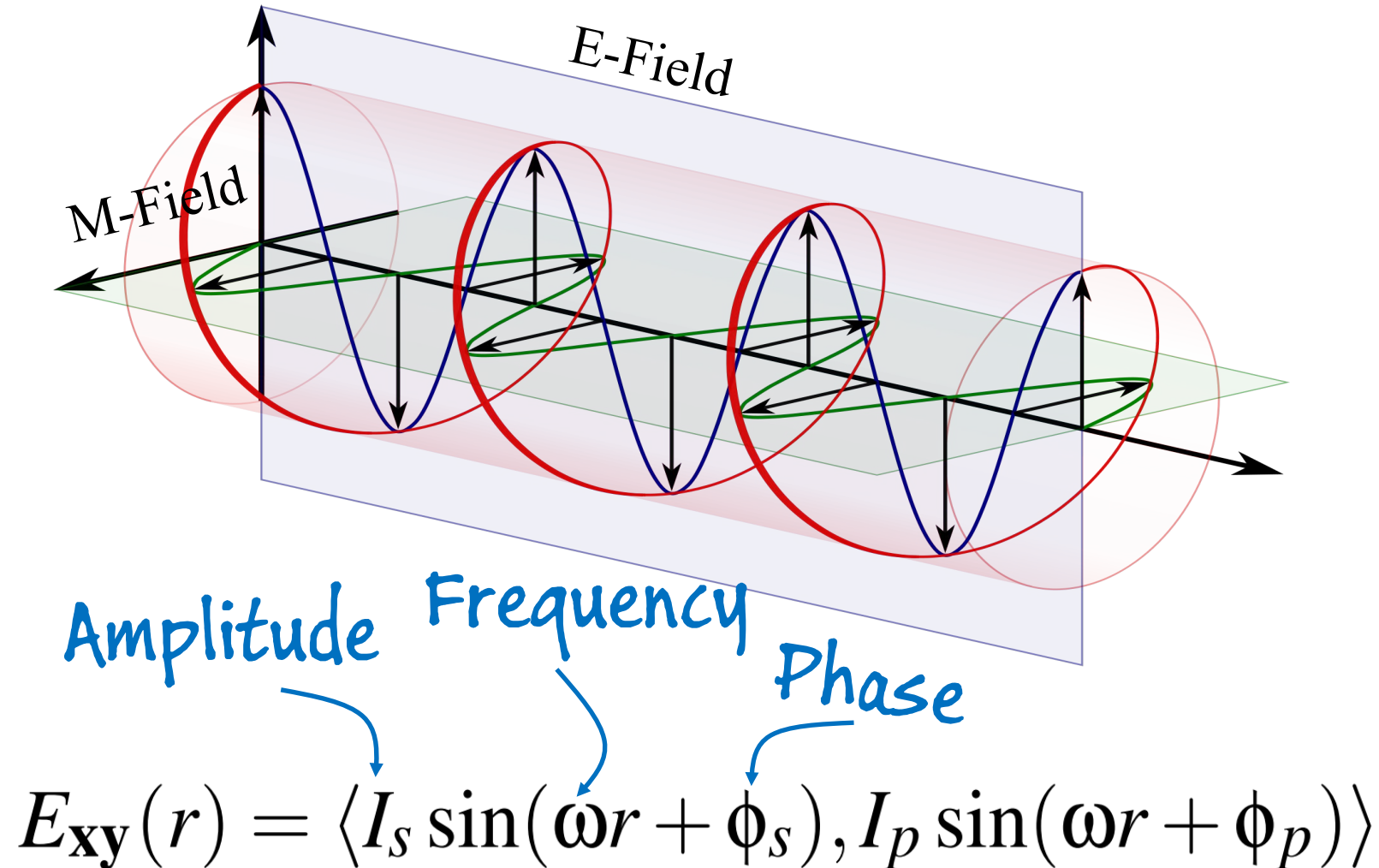


James Clerk Maxwell (1831-1879)

Light as an electromagnetic wave

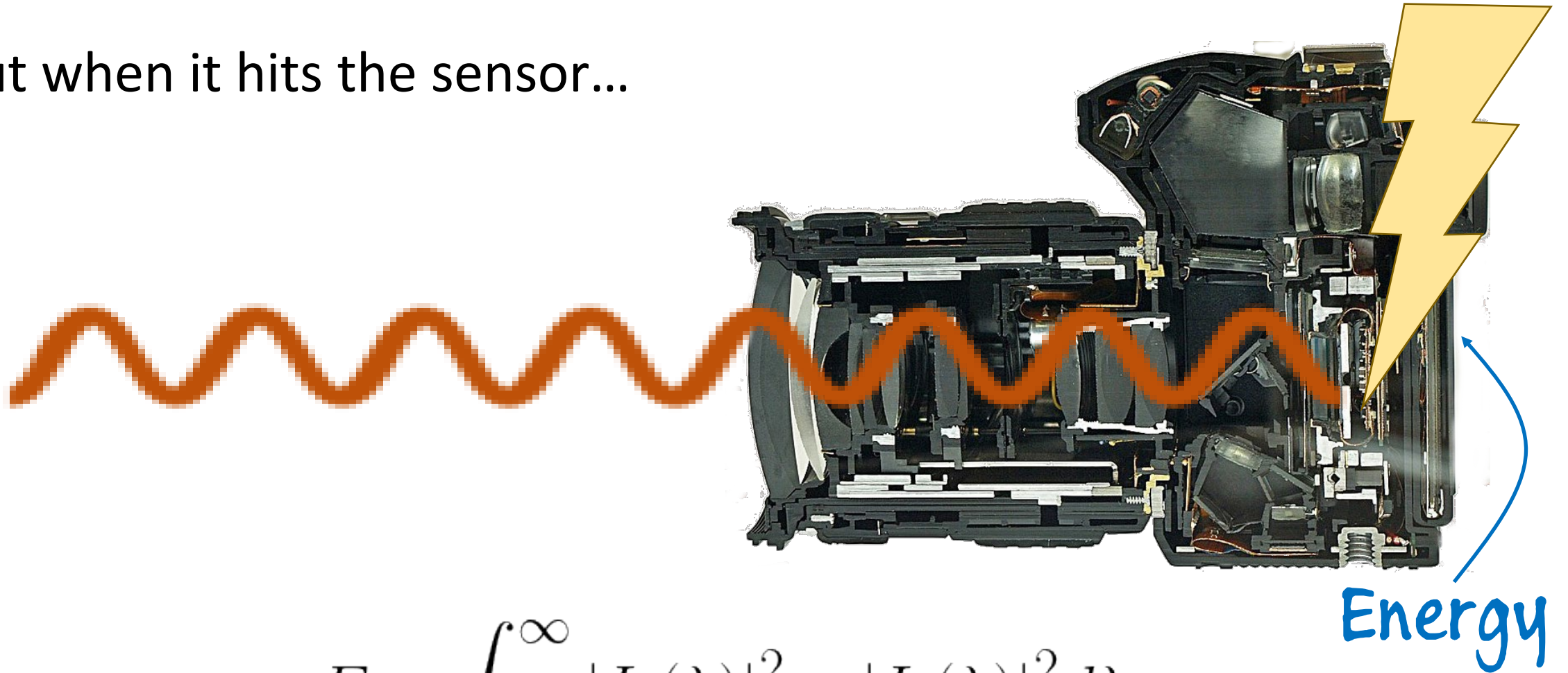


Light as an electromagnetic wave



Light as an electromagnetic wave

- But when it hits the sensor...



$$E = \int_0^{\infty} |I_p(\lambda)|^2 + |I_s(\lambda)|^2 d\lambda$$

Energy

In short... what do we capture/ what do we lose?

$$E = \int_0^{\infty} |I_p(\lambda)|^2 + |I_s(\lambda)|^2 d\lambda$$

- Cameras capture intensity (plain and simple)
- We filter this intensity to give more weight to certain wavelengths
 - Hoping to resemble human perception
- So we forever lose...
 - The **spectrally-resolved intensity**
 - The components of each phasor: **Amplitude and phase**

Plenoptic imaging

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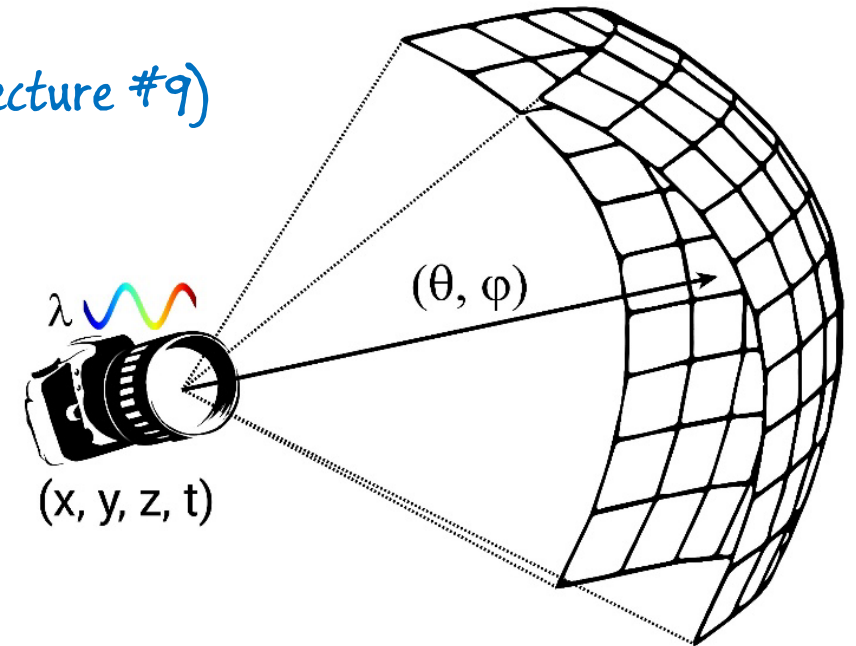
Hyperspectral imaging (Lecture #8)

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→ Hyperspectral imaging (Lecture #8)

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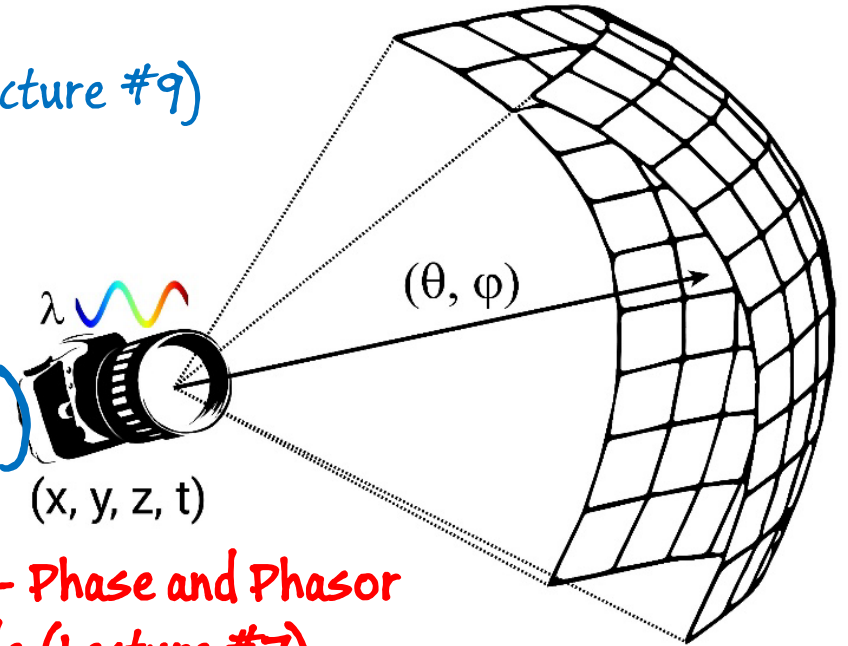
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→ Polarization - Phase and Phasor Amplitude (Lecture #7)

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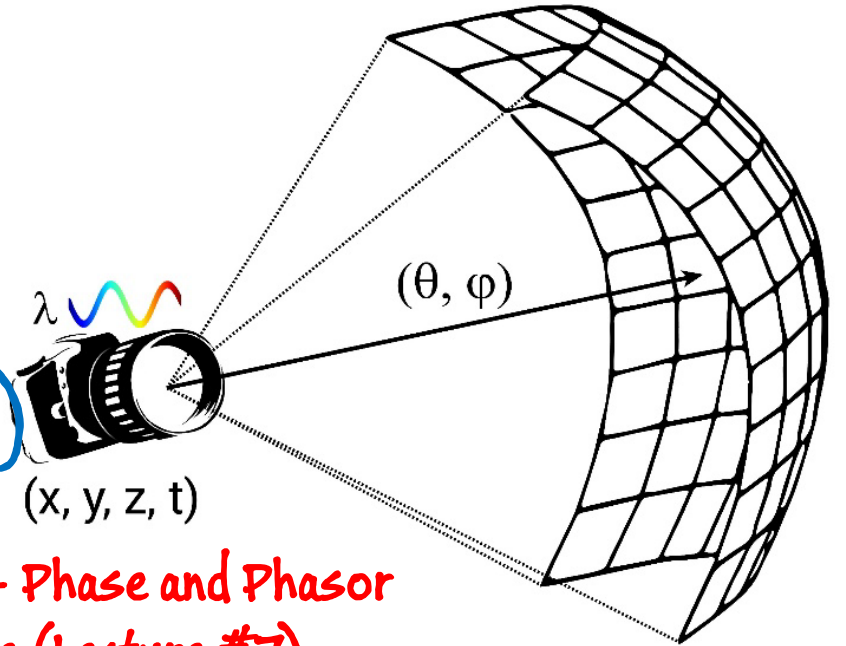


Extended Plenoptic imaging

→ Hyperspectral imaging (Lecture #8)

$$P = P(\theta, \phi, \lambda, t, x, y, z, \{s, p\})$$

→ Polarization - Phase and Phasor Amplitude (Lecture #7)



- Why are these interesting/important?
- How can we capture them back with our camera.

Questions?



James Clerk Maxwell (1831-1979)

HYPERSPECTRAL IMAGING

Hyperspectral Imaging

- **What** is it?
- **Why** is it important? (a.k.a. applications)
- **How** do we capture it?

Color

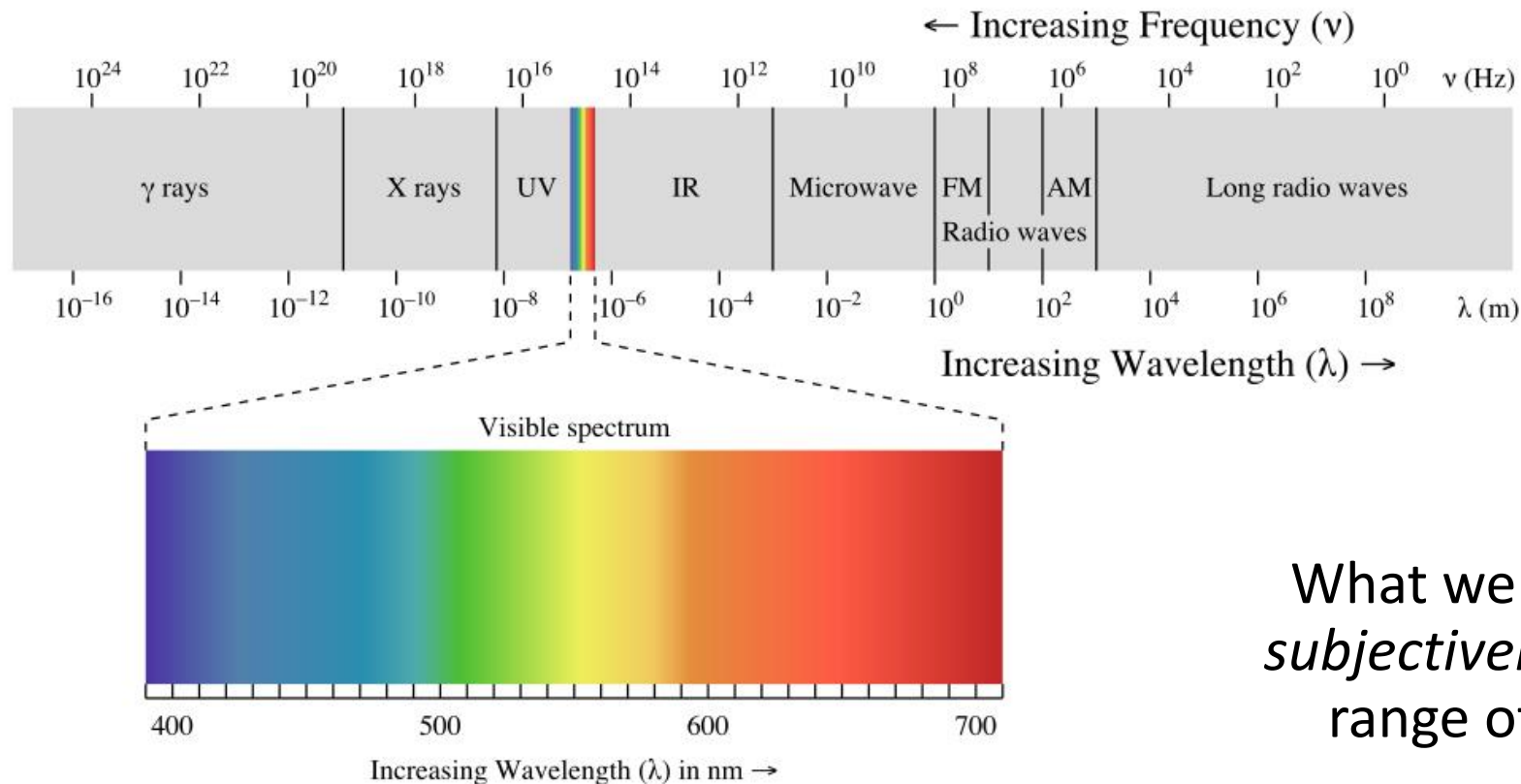
- Very high-level of color as it relates to digital photography.
- We could spend an entire course covering color.



color is complicated

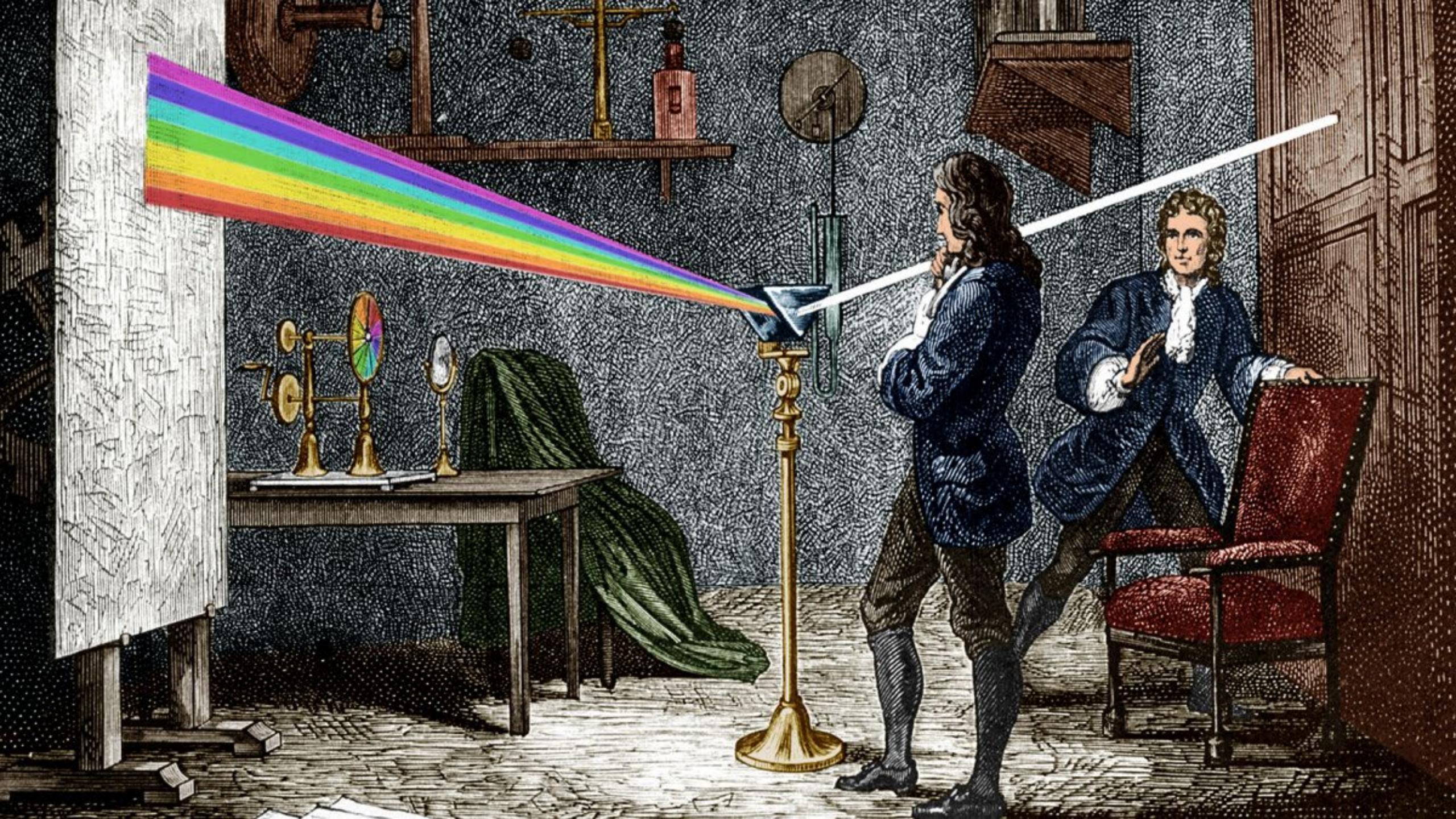
Color is an artifact of human perception

- “Color” is not an *objective* physical property of light (electromagnetic radiation).
- Instead, light is characterized by its wavelength.

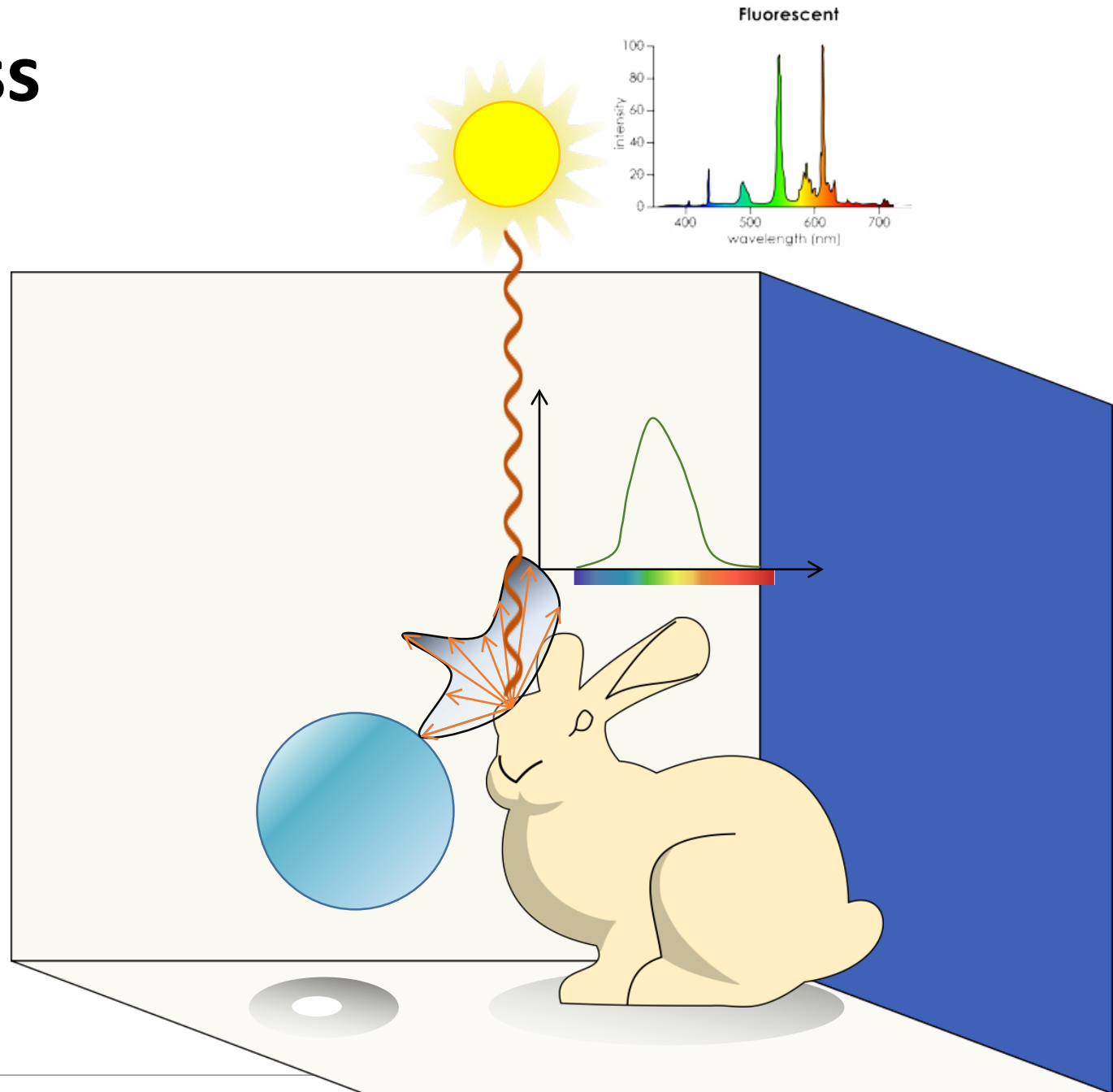


electromagnetic
spectrum

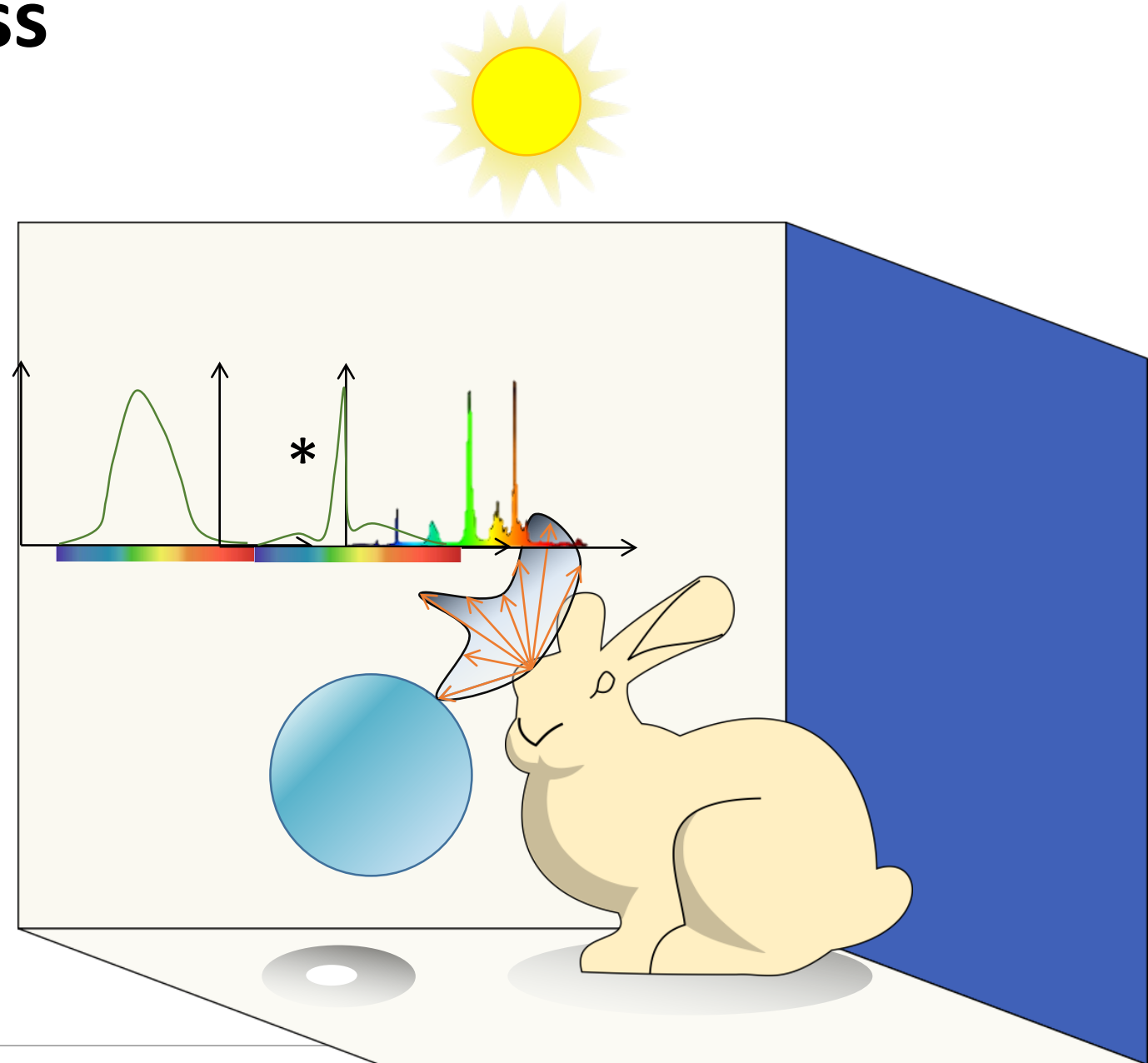
What we call “color” is how we *subjectively* perceive a very small range of these wavelengths.



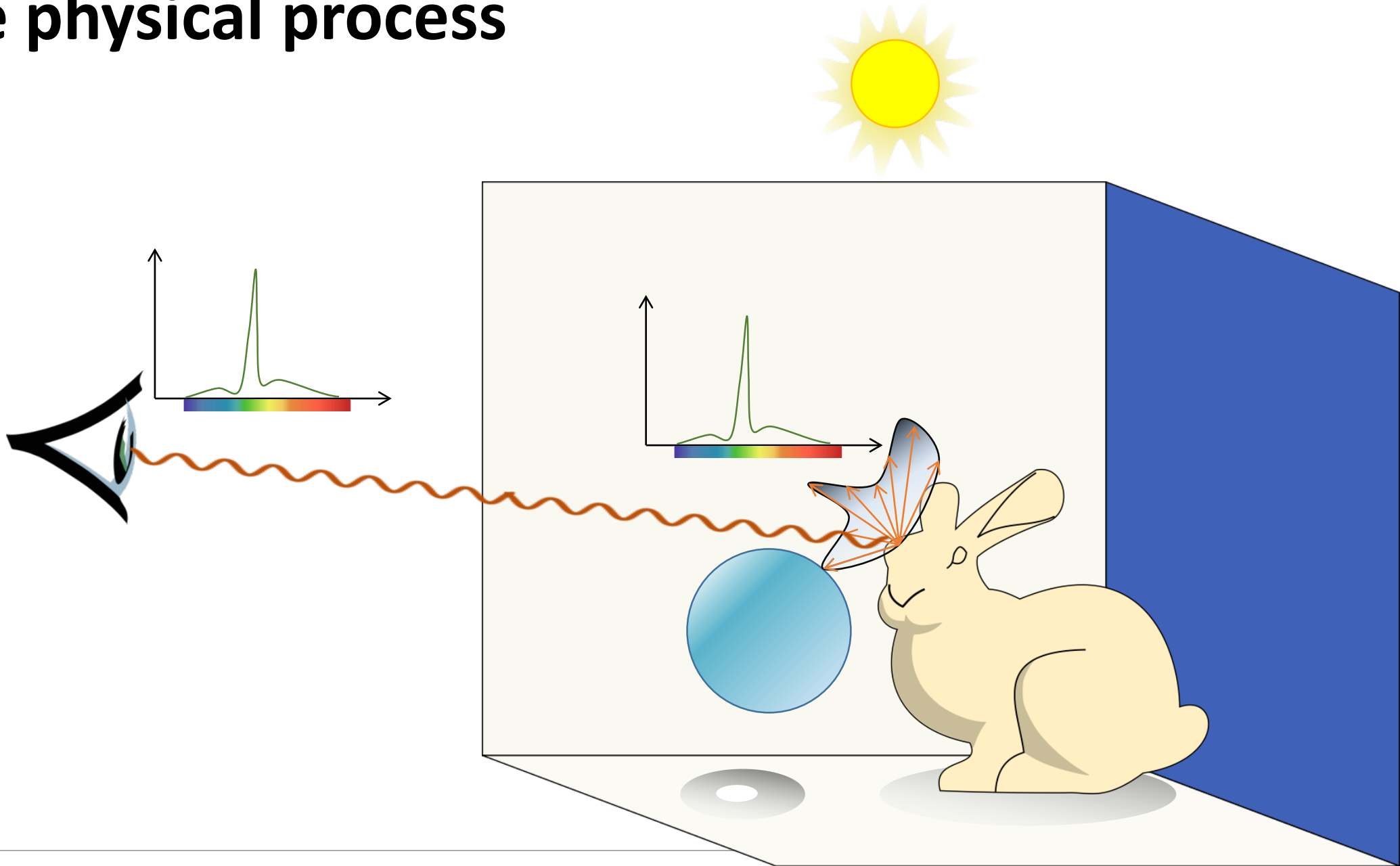
The physical process



The physical process

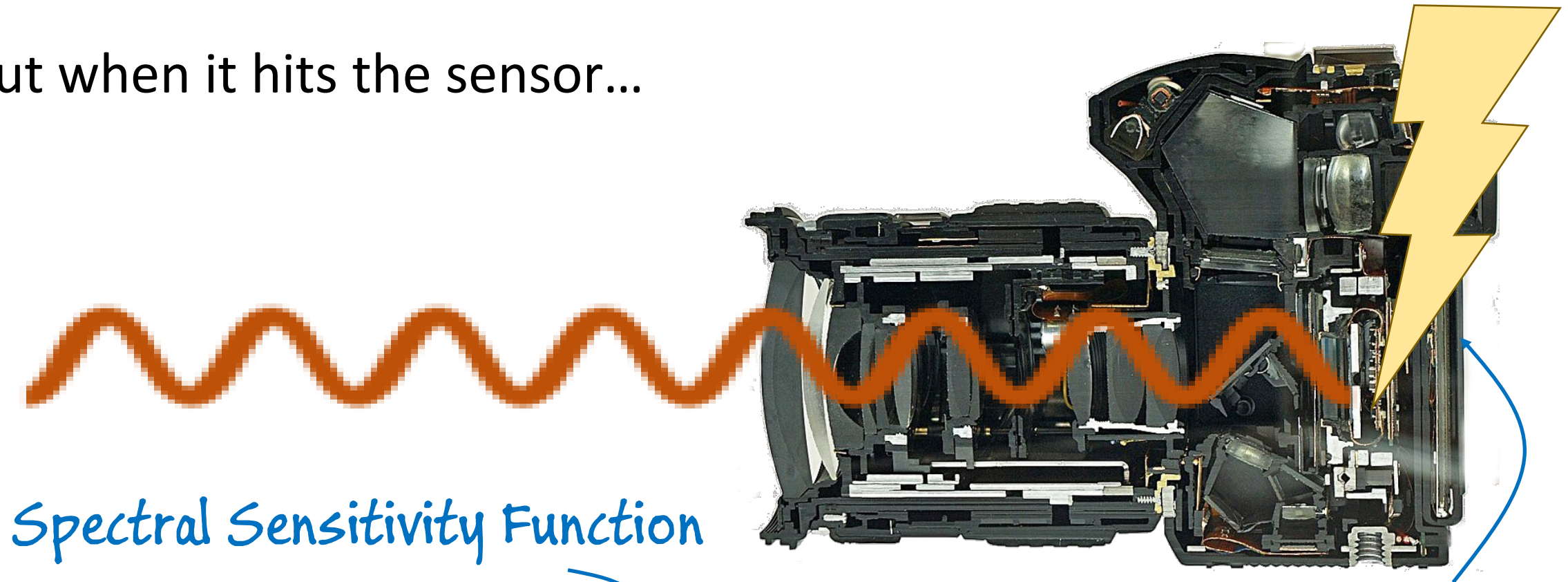


The physical process



Light as an electromagnetic wave

- But when it hits the sensor...



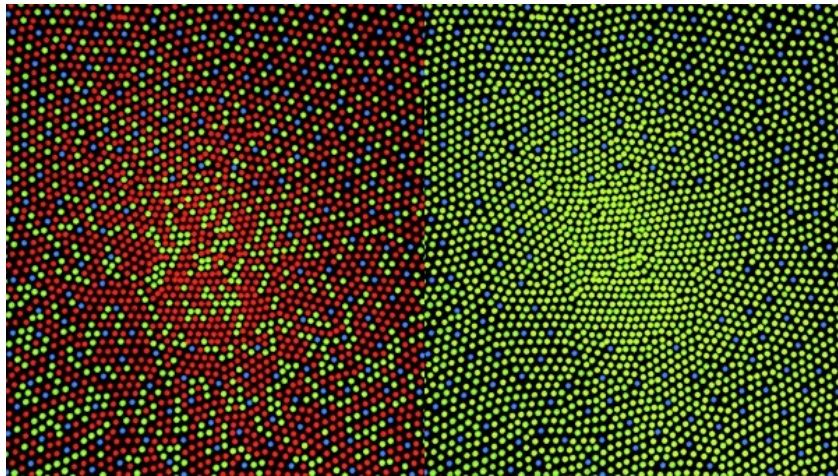
Spectral Sensitivity Function

$$E = \int_0^{\infty} |S_p(\lambda)|^2 \left(|I_p(\lambda)|^2 + |I_s(\lambda)|^2 \right) d\lambda$$

Energy

Remember – SSF of Human Eyes

- The human eye is a collection of light sensors called cone cells.
- There are three types of cells with different spectral sensitivity functions.
- Human color perception is three-dimensional (*tristimulus color*).

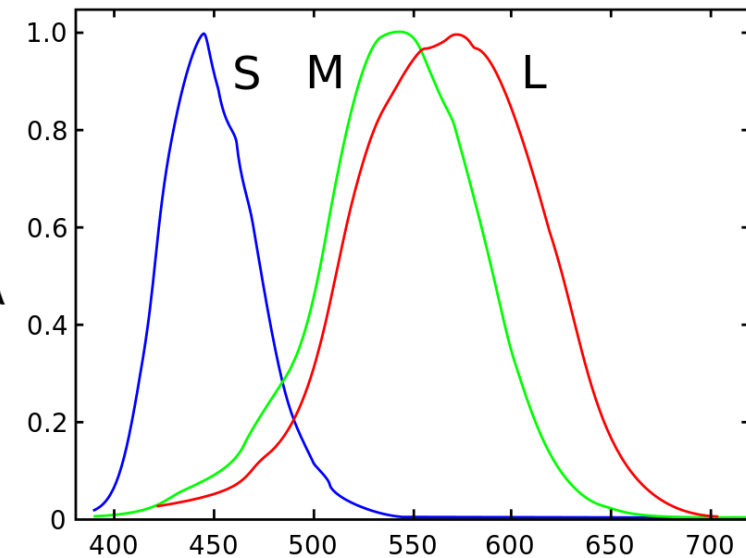


cone distribution for normal vision
(64% L, 32% M)

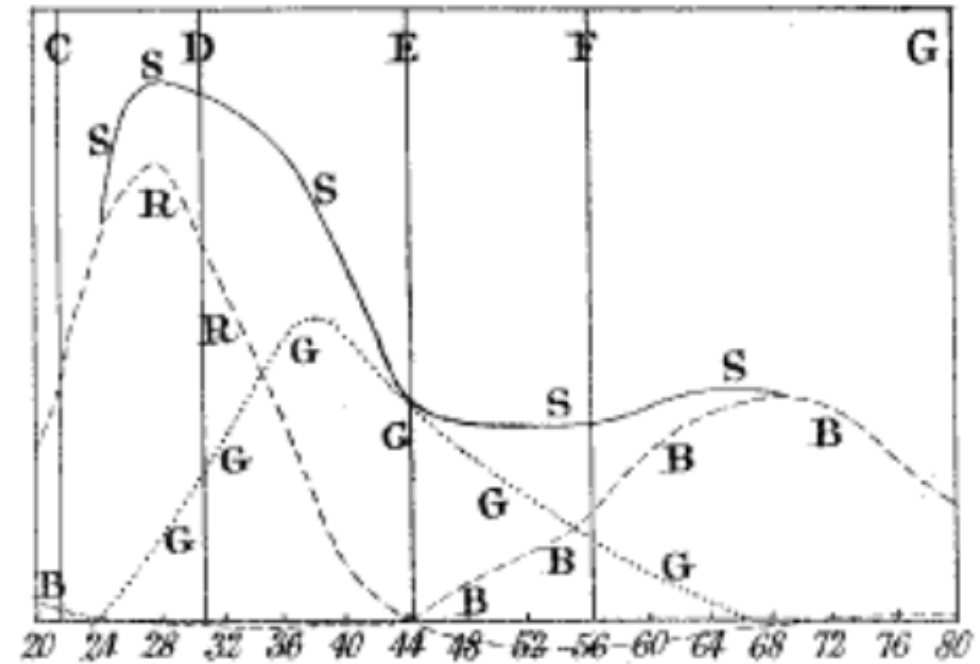
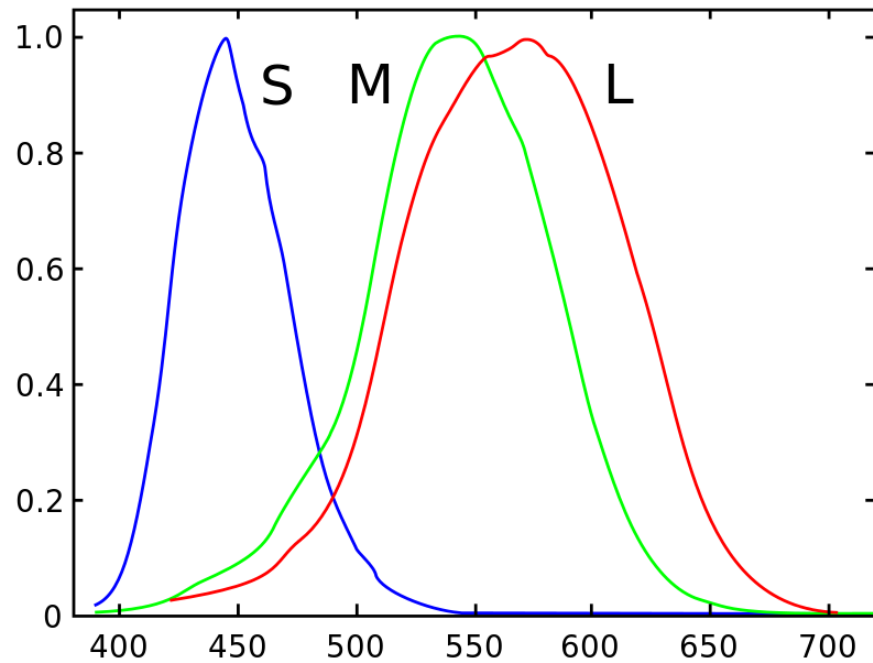
“short” $S = \int_{\lambda} \Phi(\lambda) S(\lambda) d\lambda$

“medium” $M = \int_{\lambda} \Phi(\lambda) M(\lambda) d\lambda$

“long” $L = \int_{\lambda} \Phi(\lambda) L(\lambda) d\lambda$



Remember – SSF of Human Eyes



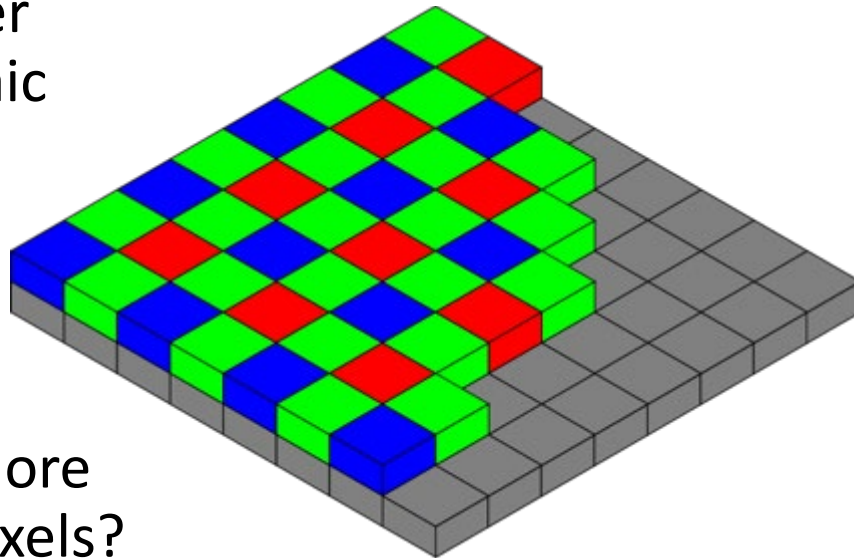
James Clerk Maxwell, 1860. "On the Theory of Compound Colours, and the Relations of the Colours of the Spectrum."
Philosophical Transactions of the Royal Society of London

Remember – SSF of Digital Cameras

Two design choices:

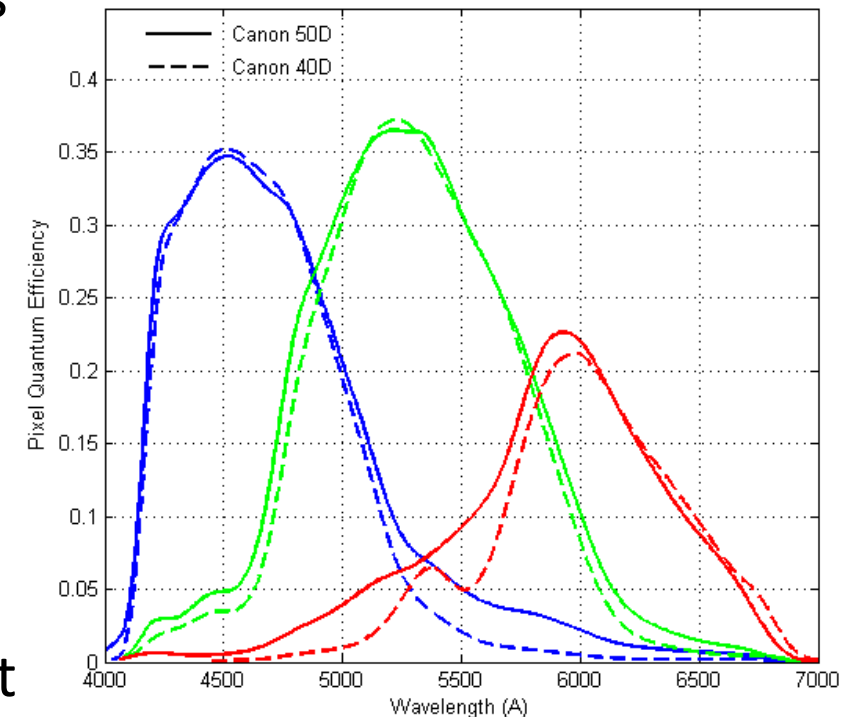
- What spectral sensitivity functions $f(\lambda)$ to use for each color filter?
- How to spatially arrange (“mosaic”) different color filters

Bayer
mosaic



Why more
green pixels?

SSF for
Canon 50D



Generally do not
match human LMS.

$f(\lambda)$

Remember – Each Dig. Camera has its own SSF

Each camera has its more or less unique, and most of the time *secret*, SSF.

- Makes it very difficult to correctly reproduce the color of sensor measurements.



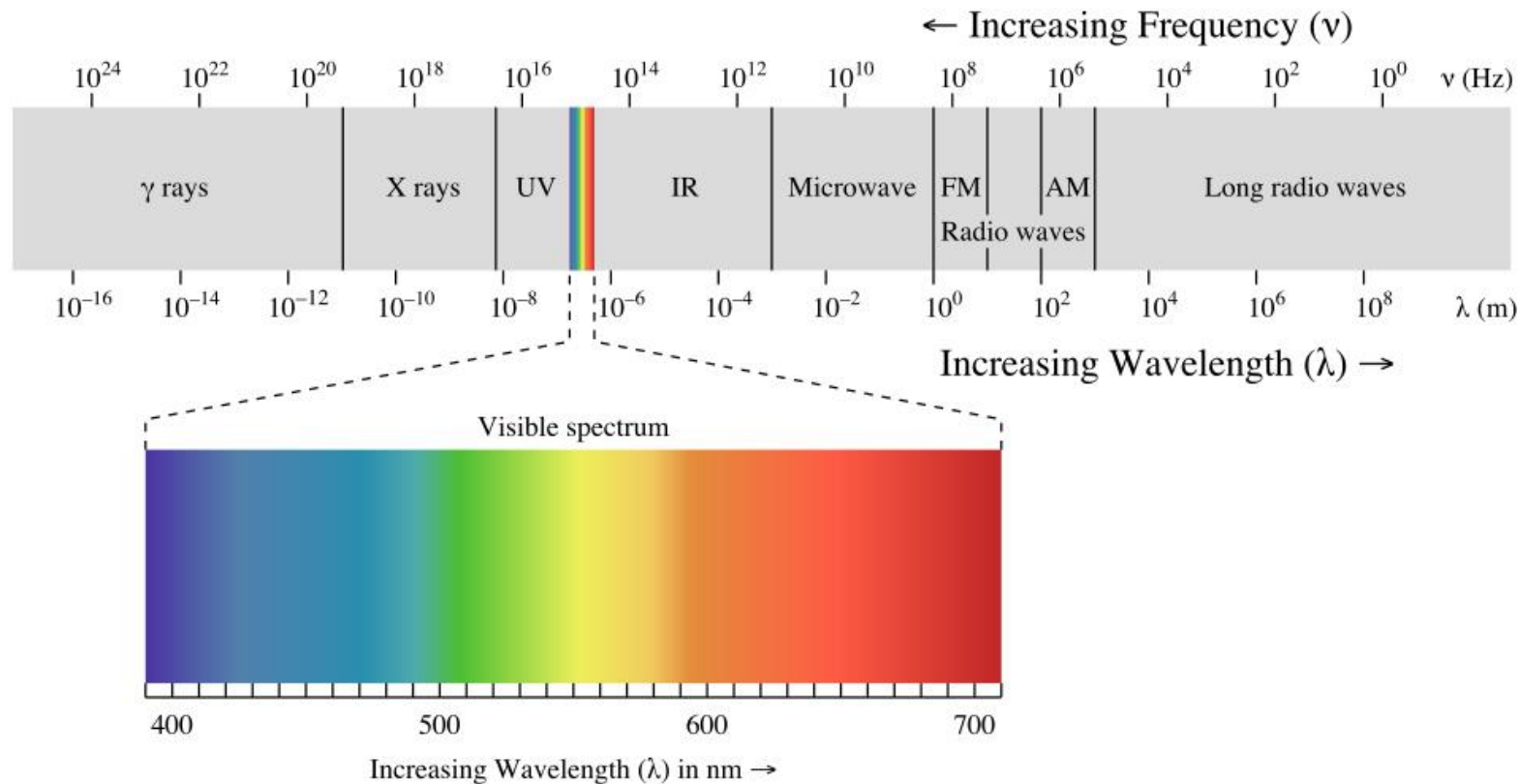
So...

- Cameras (and our eyes) do not capture the electromagnetic spectrum
- As best, they coarsely sample the spectrum by filtering out frequencies
 - Not even that...
- (Very) incomplete description of the EM field/reflectance.
 - Spectroradiometry != Color

Hyperspectral Imaging

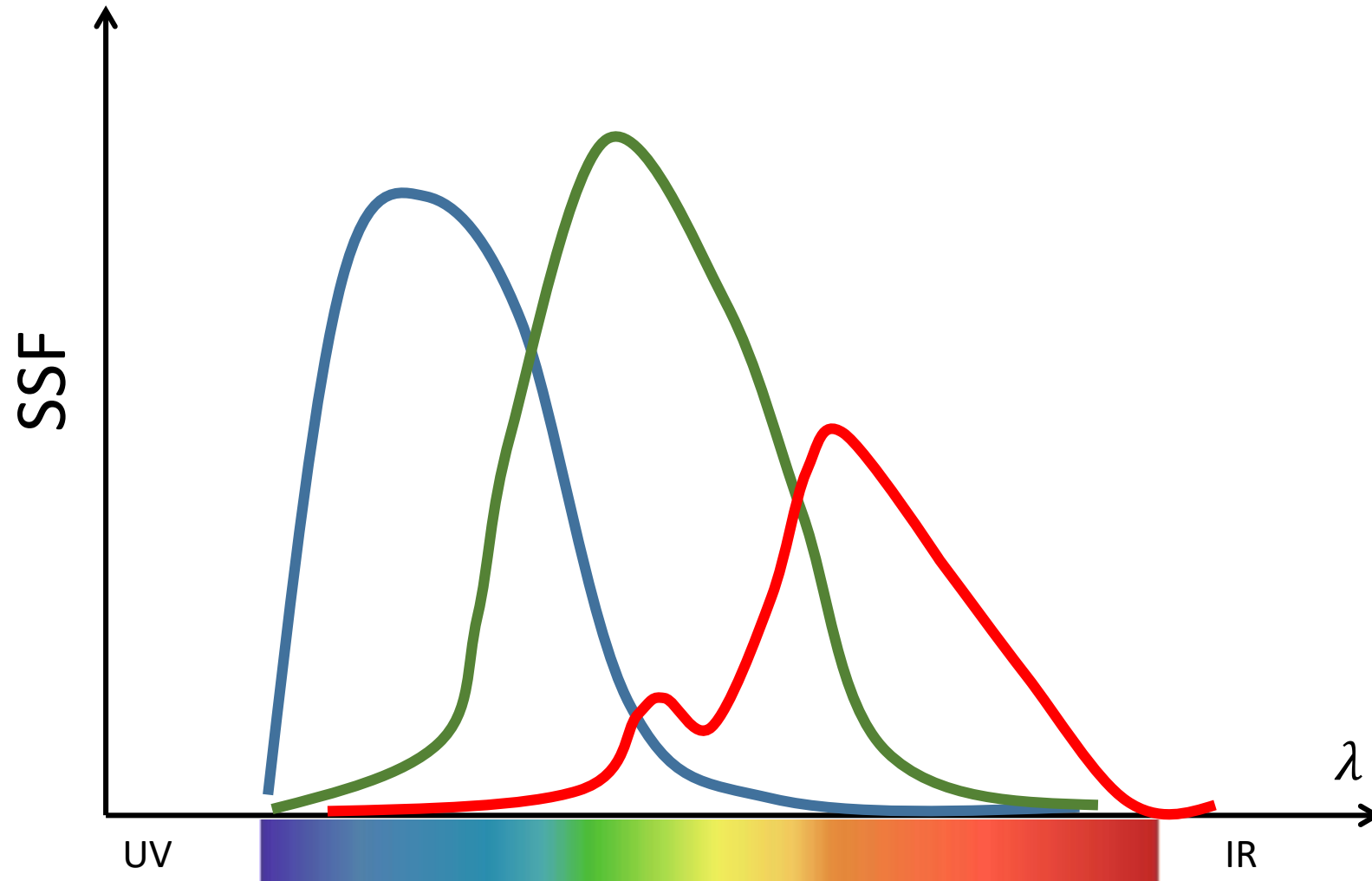
- Cameras (and eyes) do not capture the electromagnetic range
- ... in fact, little-to-none sensitivity out of the visible spectrum
- **Hyperspectral imaging** tries to:
 - a) Sample more finely the EM spectrum
 - b) Recover (part of) the frequencies outside the visible

EM Spectrum

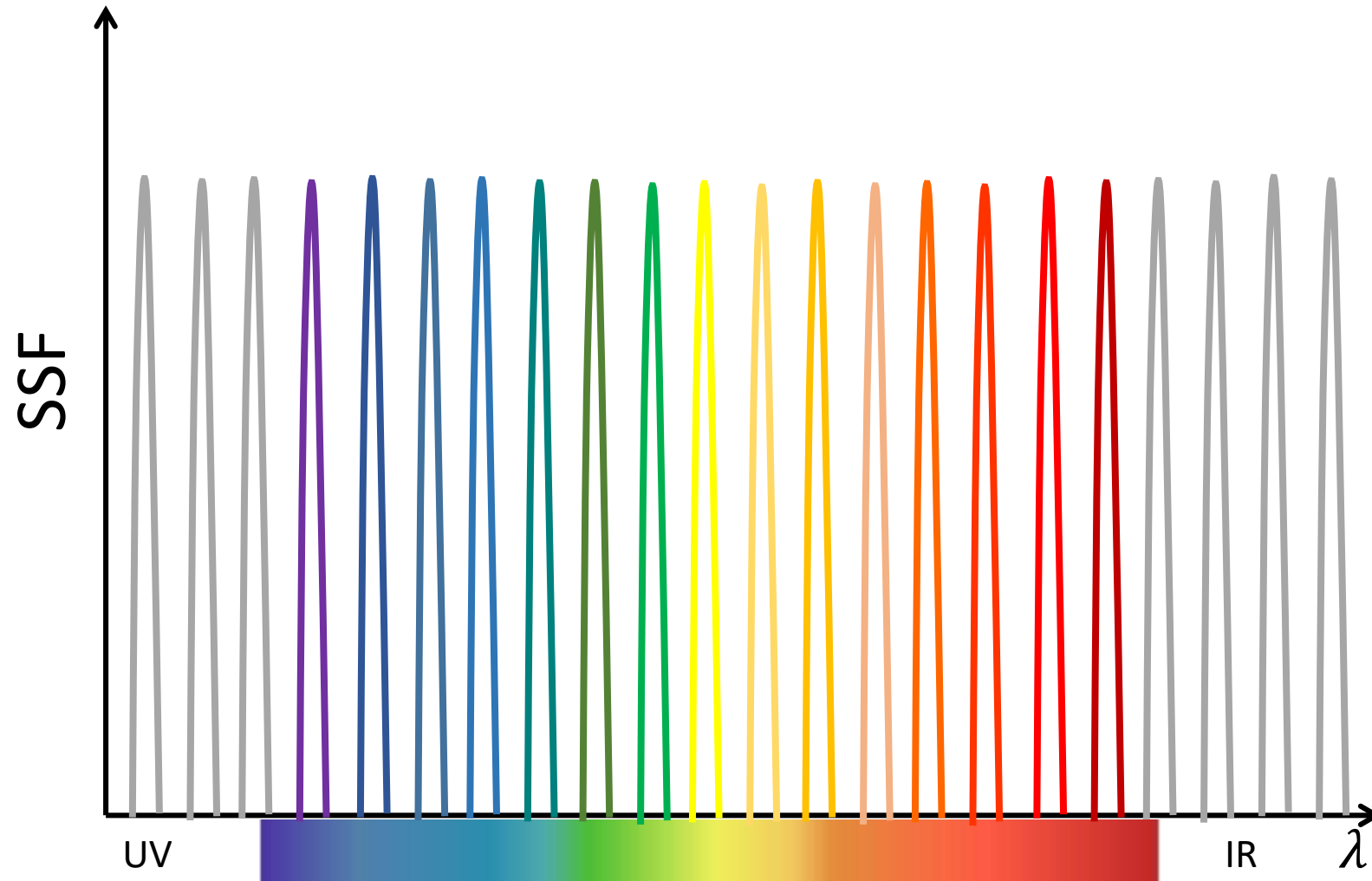


electromagnetic
spectrum

EM Spectrum



EM Spectrum

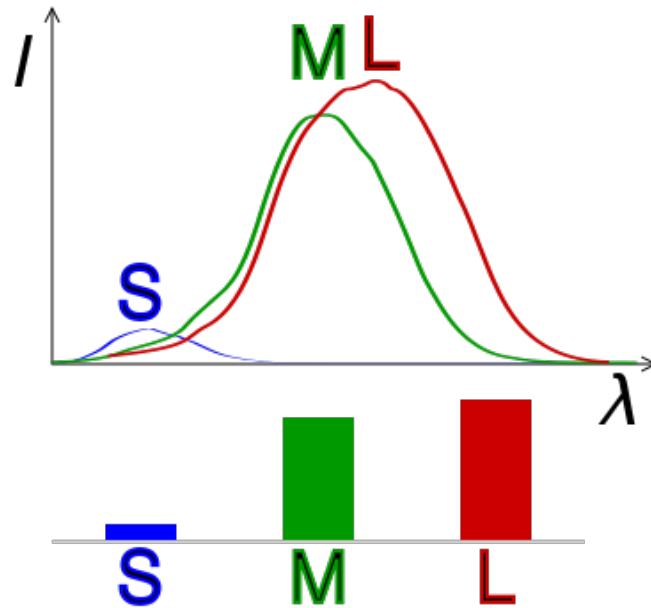
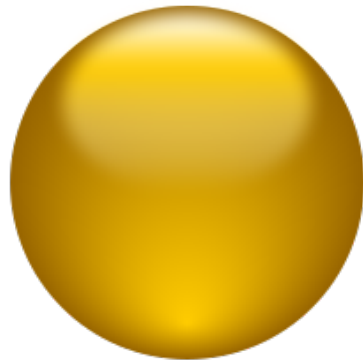


Why do we want to capture the full spectrum?

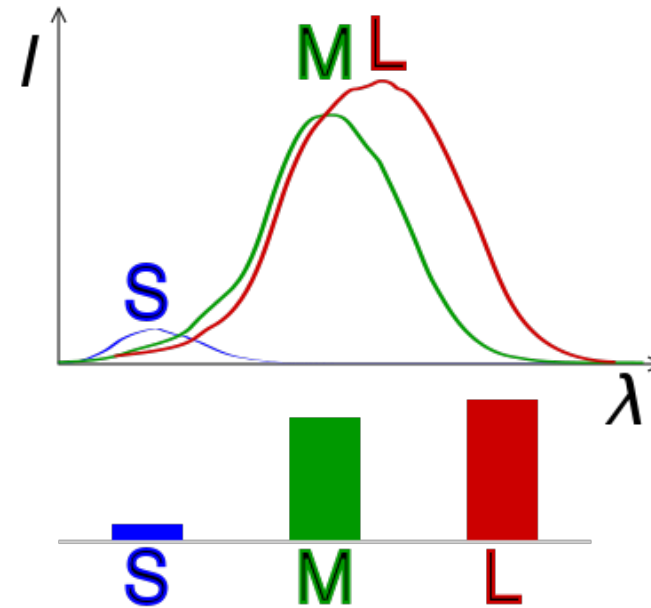
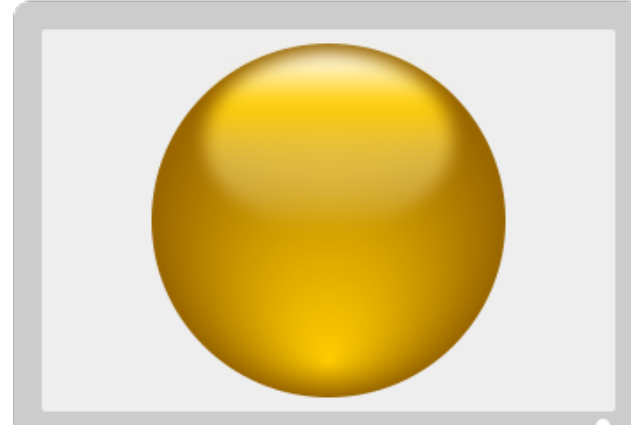
- We have seen that we are missing lots of (visual) info about the EM spectrum...
- ... but how important is that info?
- Remember that RGB is optimized to our visual system
- **Brainstorming:** Where would we like to have HS info?

Metamerism (I)

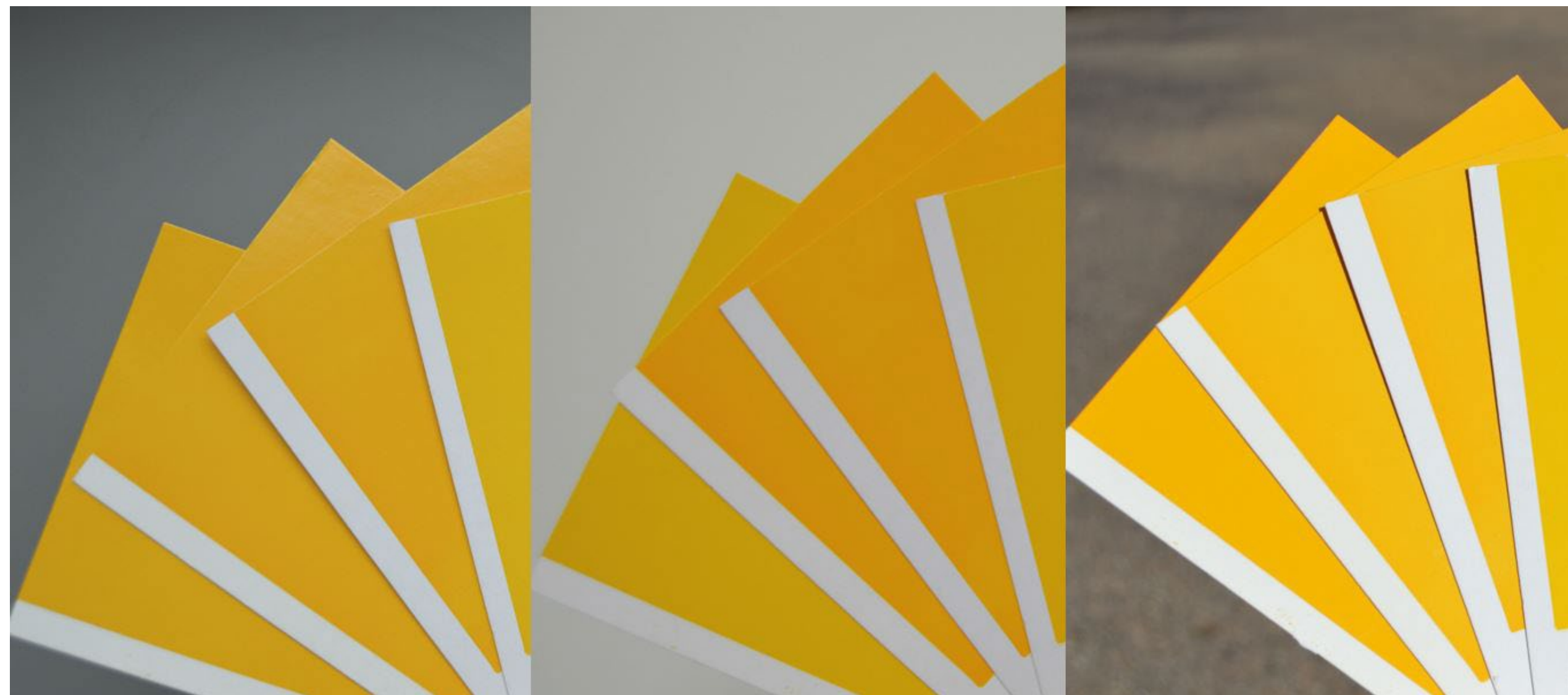
1.



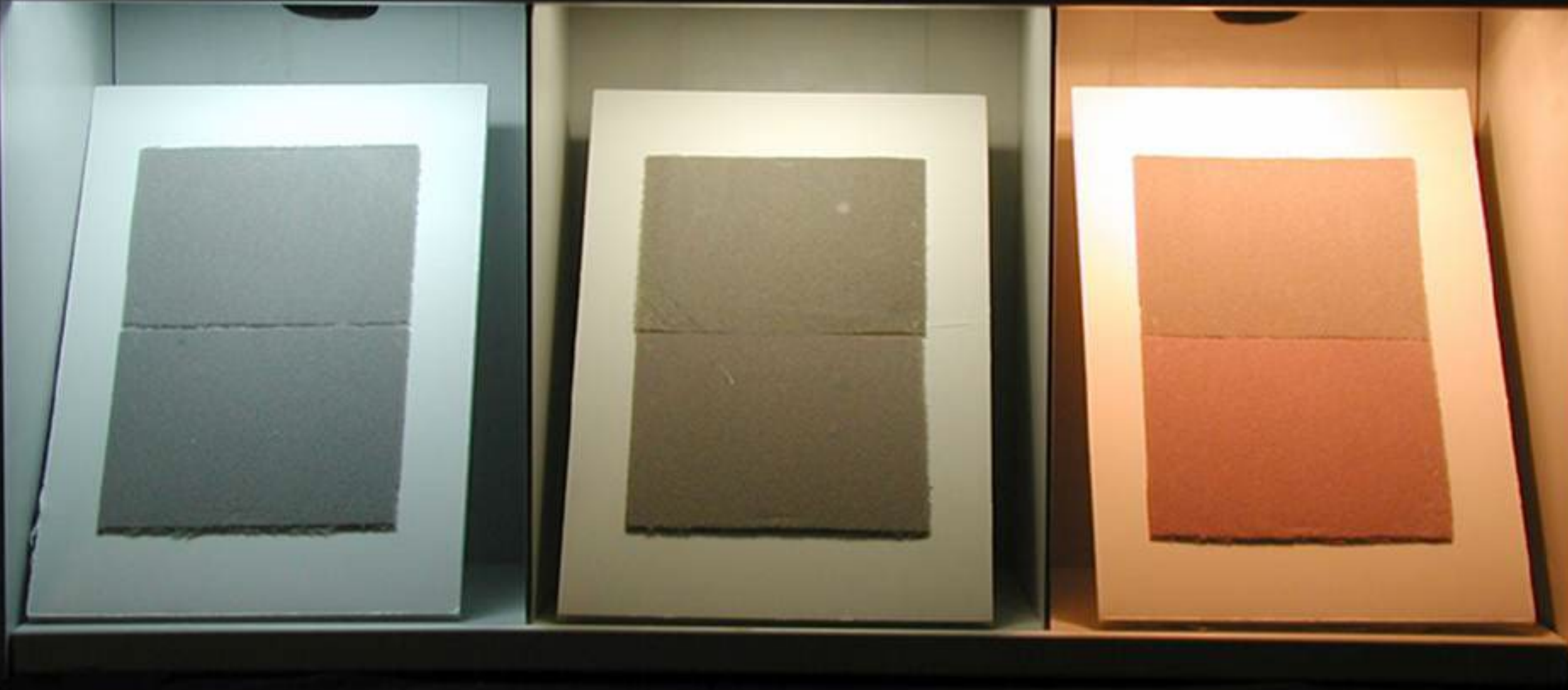
2.



Metamerism (II)



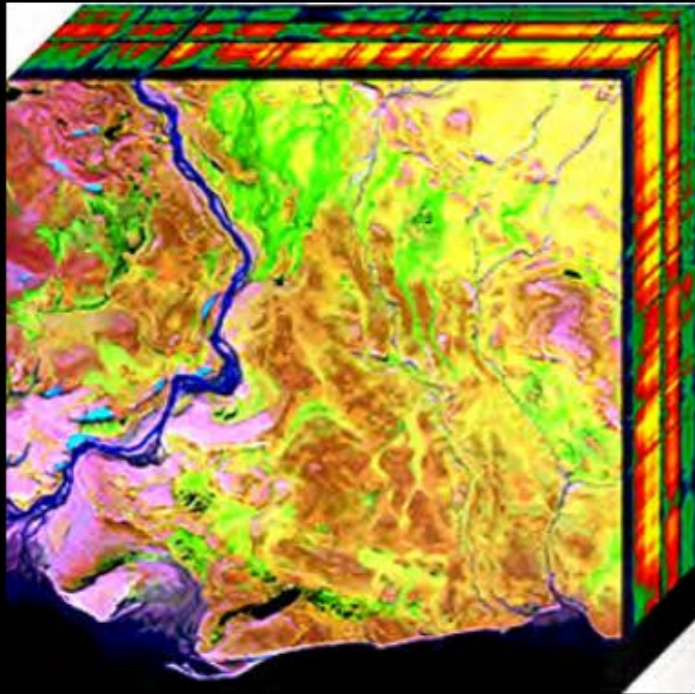
Metamerism (III)



Why do we want to capture the full spectrum?

- We have seen that we are missing lots of (visual) info about the EM spectrum...
- ... but how important is that info?
- Remember that RGB is optimized to our visual system
- **Brainstorming:** Where would we like to have HS info?

Hyperspectral Imaging – *Where is it important?*



Geology [1]

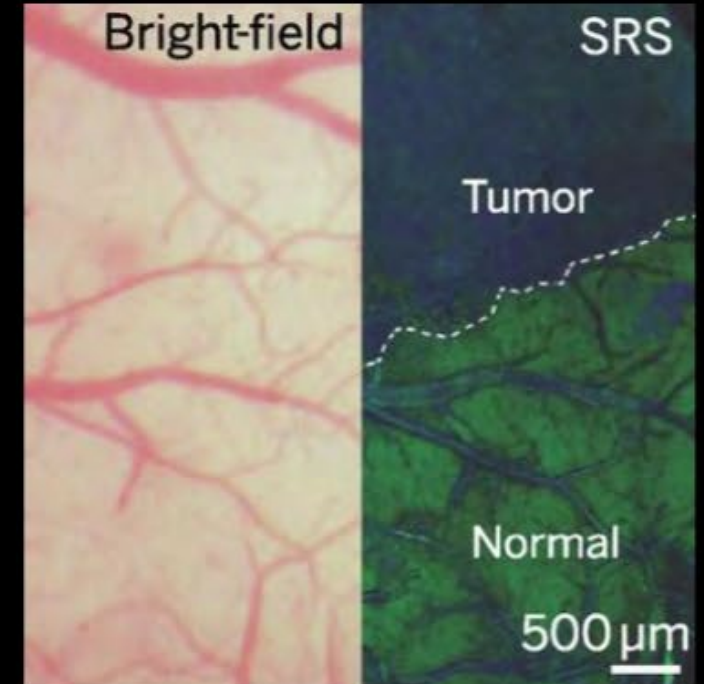


Visible



UV

Cosmetics [2]



Biology [3]

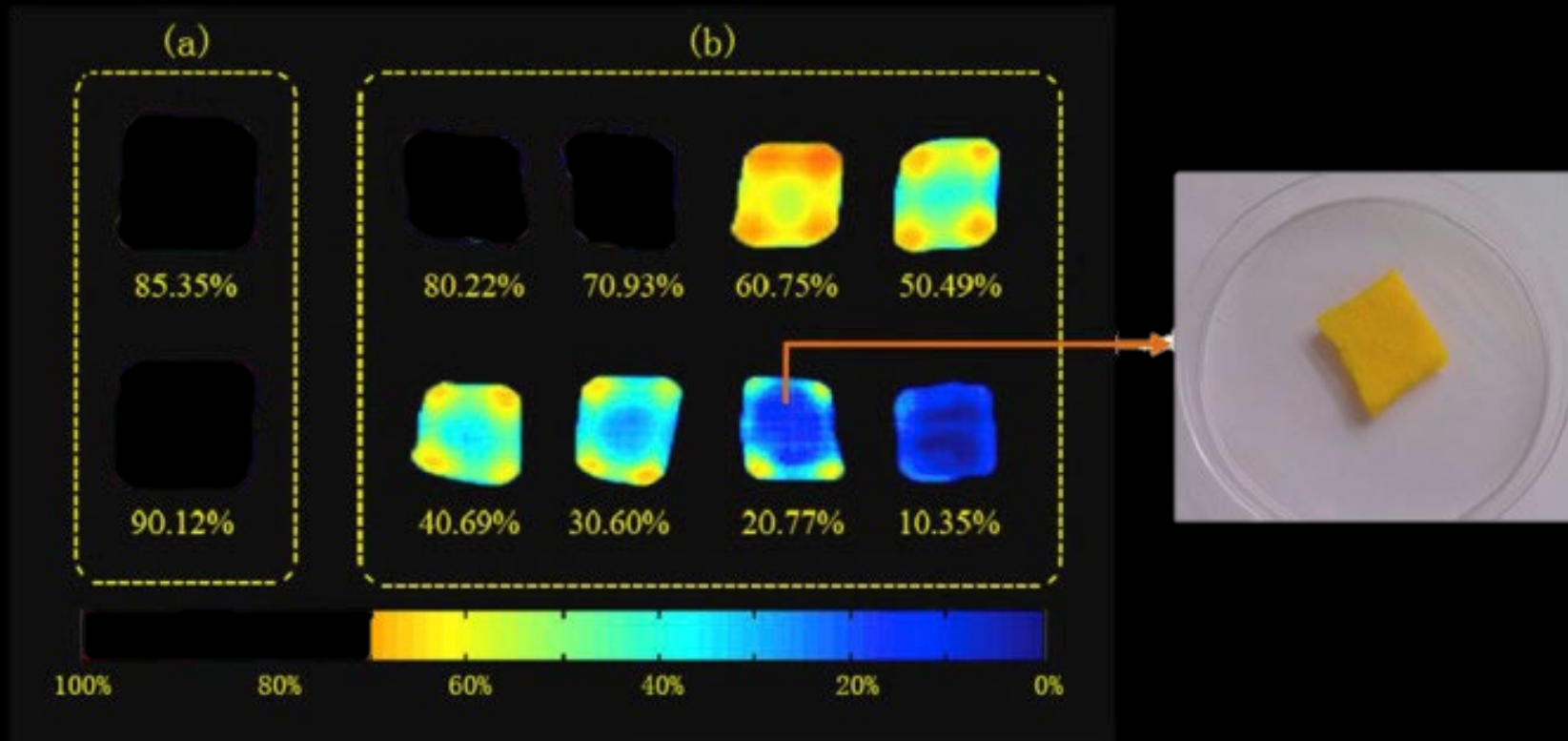
[1] NASA

[3] rshephorse, Flickr

[2] Cheng et al., Vibrational spectroscopic imaging of living systems: An emerging platform for biology and medicine, Science 2015

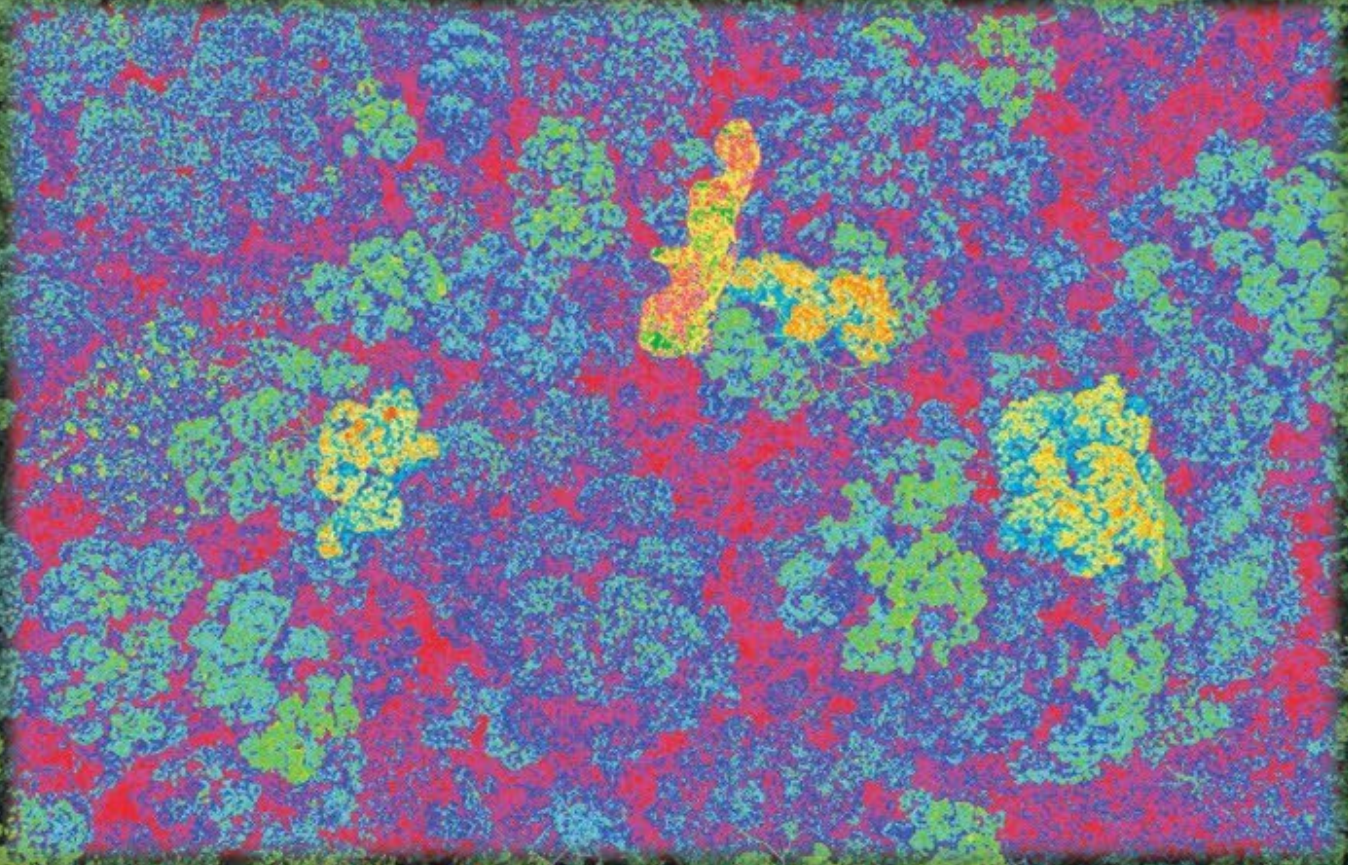
Hyperspectral Imaging – *Where is it important?*

Quality Control

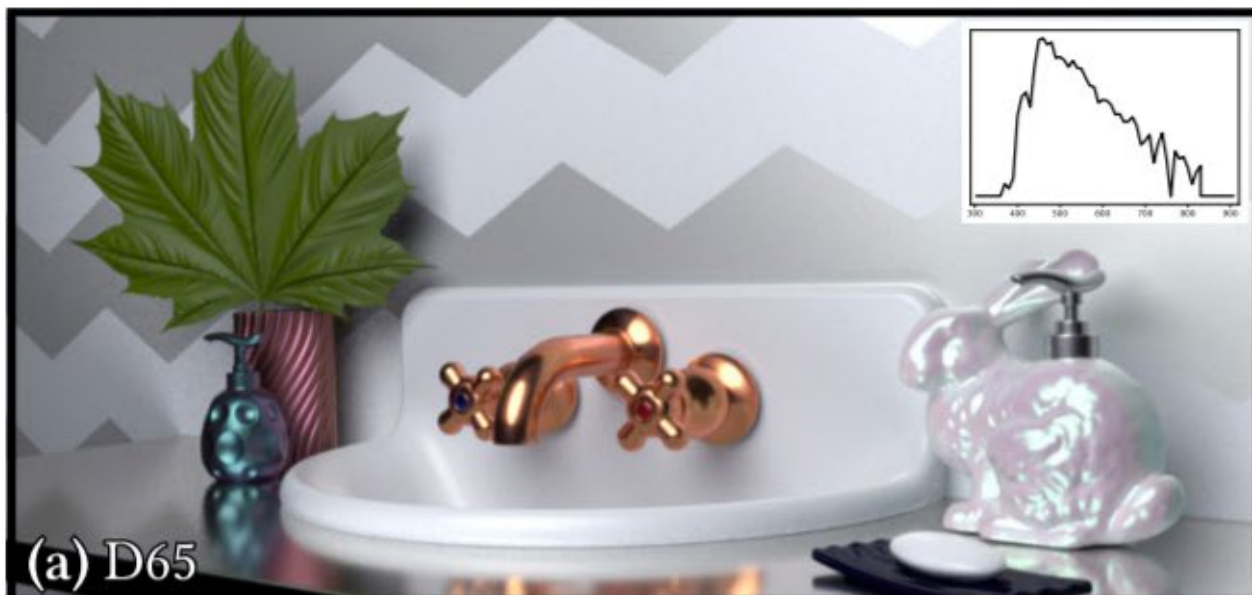


Hyperspectral Imaging – *Where is it important?*

Remote Sensing









Source: [Alvarez-Cortes et al. 2015]



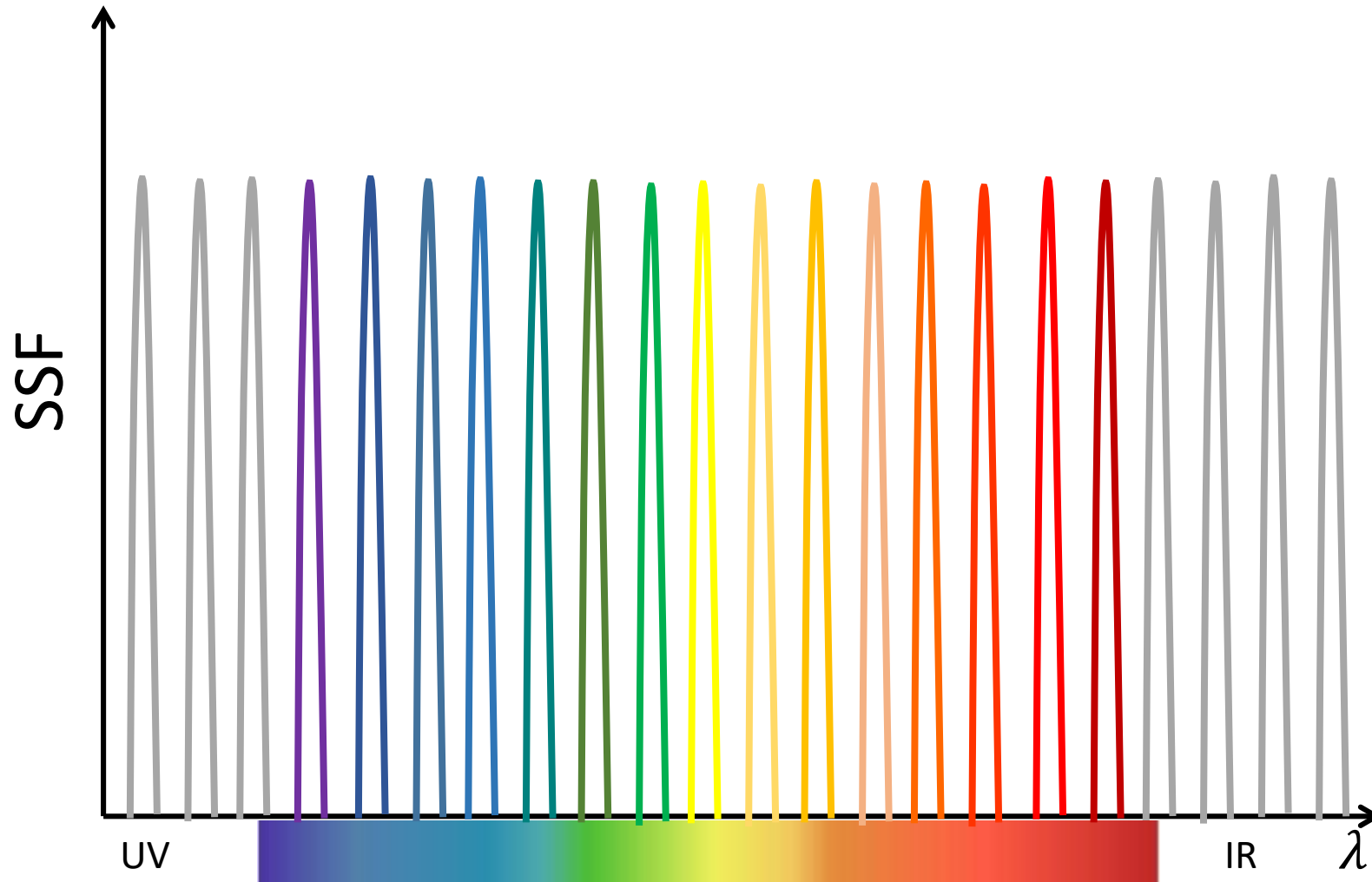
Dawn of the Planet of the Apes © 20th Century Fox

Questions?

Hyperspectral Imaging

- What is it?
- Why is it important? (a.k.a. applications)
- How do we capture it?
 - **Brainstorming!**

Hyperspectral Imaging – *The naïve approach*



Hyperspectral Imaging – *The naïve approach*

- **Note:** Hyperspectral cameras exist in the market
 - But they are very expensive (25K-100K)



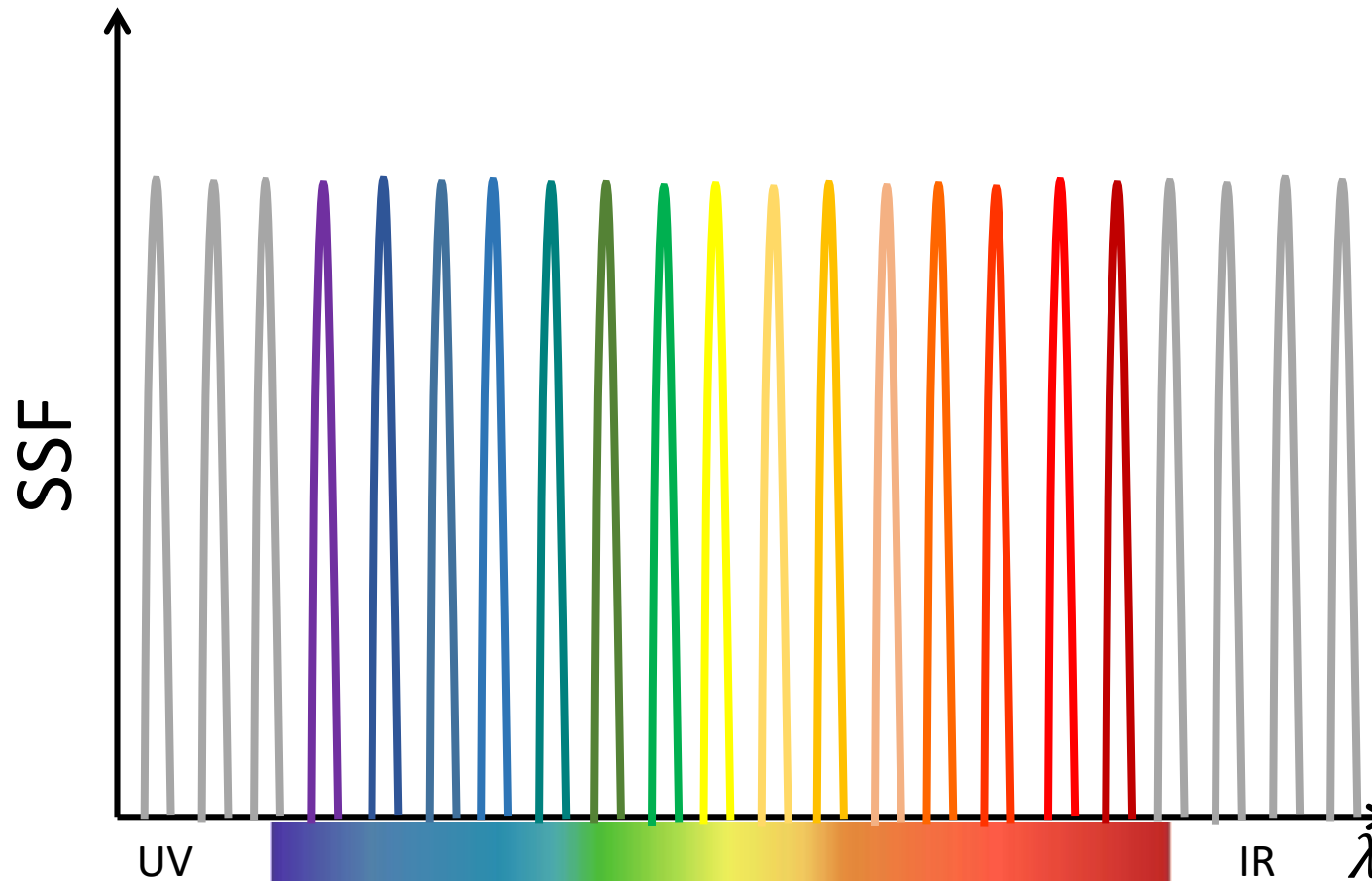
Bandpass filter
[Mansouri et al. 2007]



LCTF (liquid crystal tunable filter)
[Attas et al. 2003]

- Static Scenes only
- Low spatial resolution

Hyperspectral Imaging – *The naïve approach*



- **Brainstorming:**

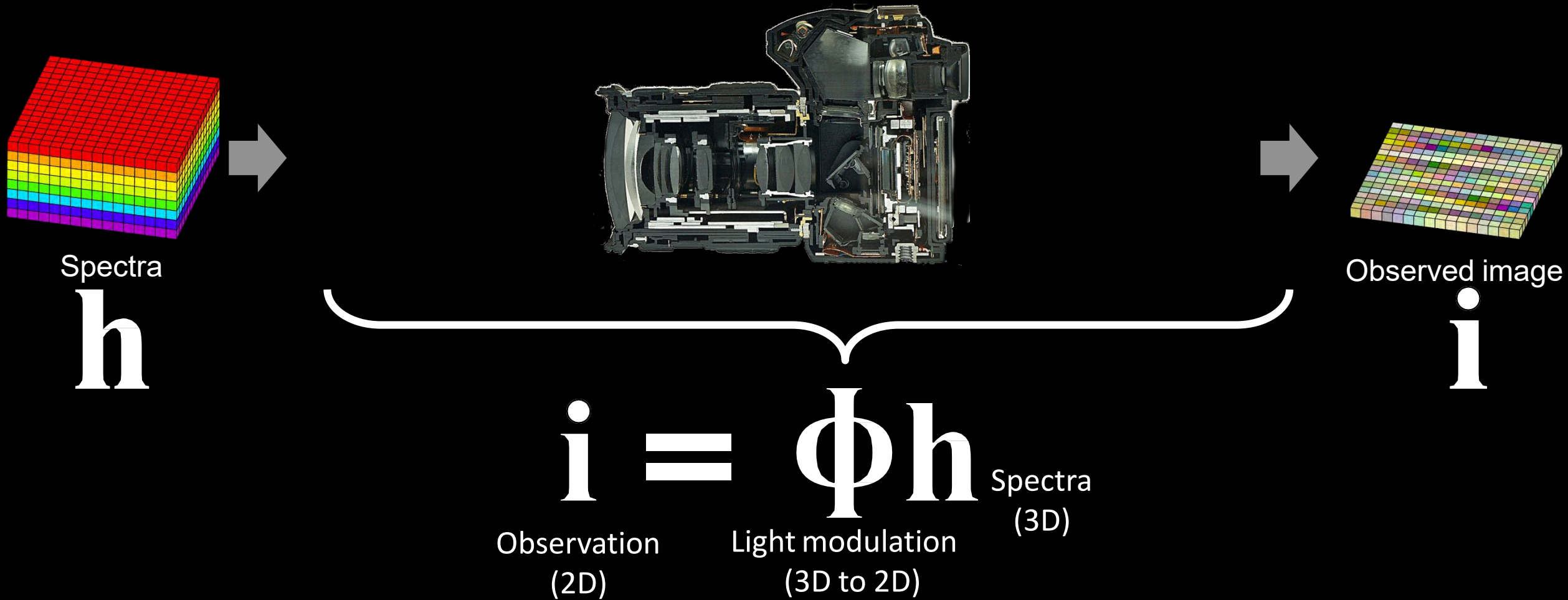
Can we do this with a conventional (i.e. no filters) camera?

Questions?

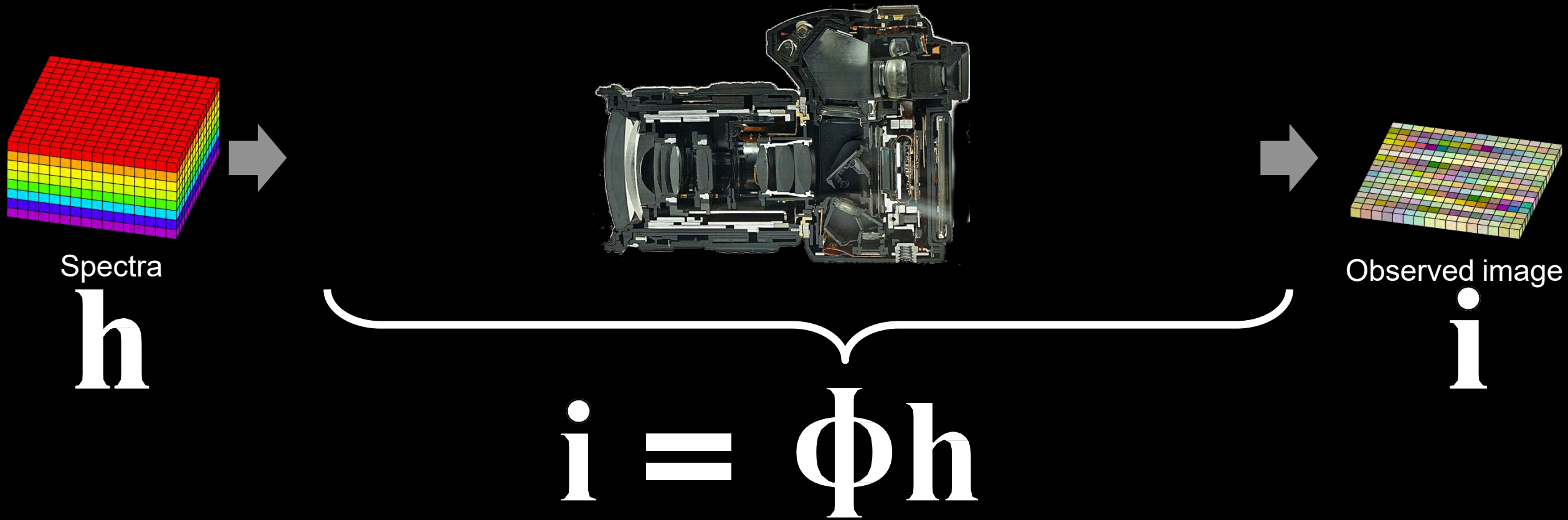
Hyperspectral Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

- **Spectral scanning** – *Naïve approach*
 - *Static scenes only, low spatial resolution*
- **Reconstruction-Based** – *The Comp. Img. Approach*
 - *Code the recorded signal; use computation for reconstruction*

Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging

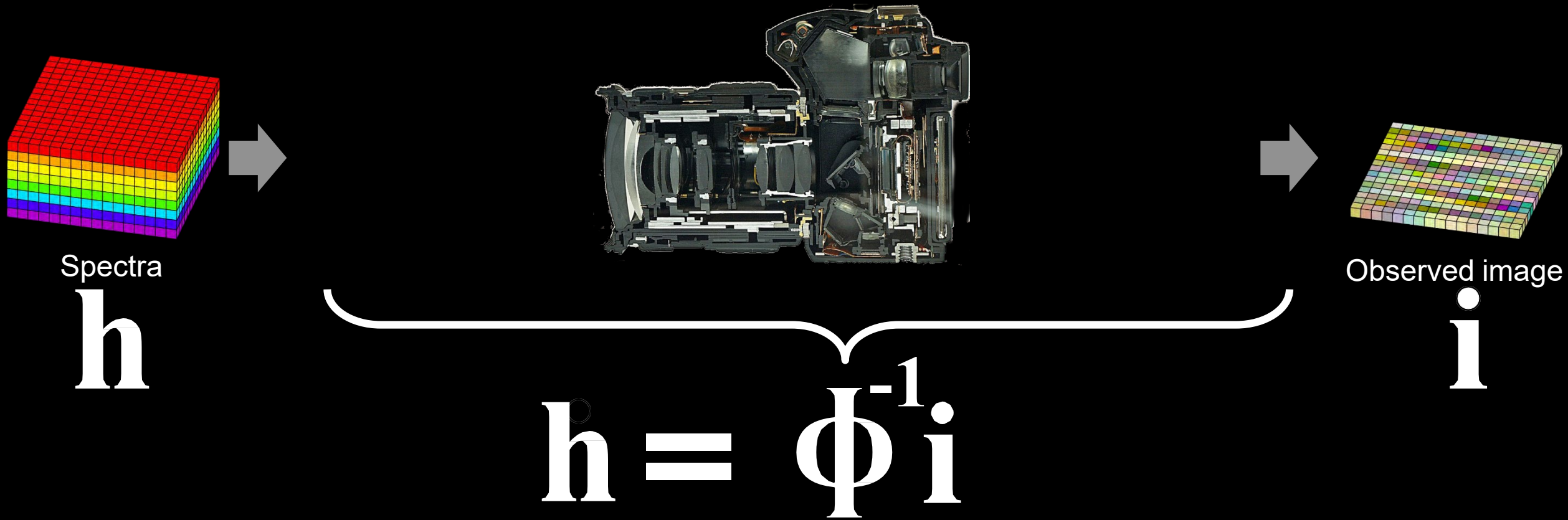


Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



Reconstruction is an inverse problem of optical imaging

Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



Reconstruction is an inverse problem of optical imaging

Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging

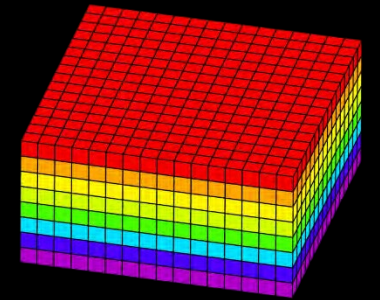
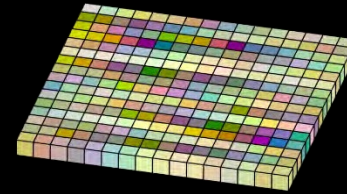
Key: Find a good image formation

$$\min_{\mathbf{h}} \left\| \mathbf{i} - \Phi \mathbf{h} \right\|_2^2$$

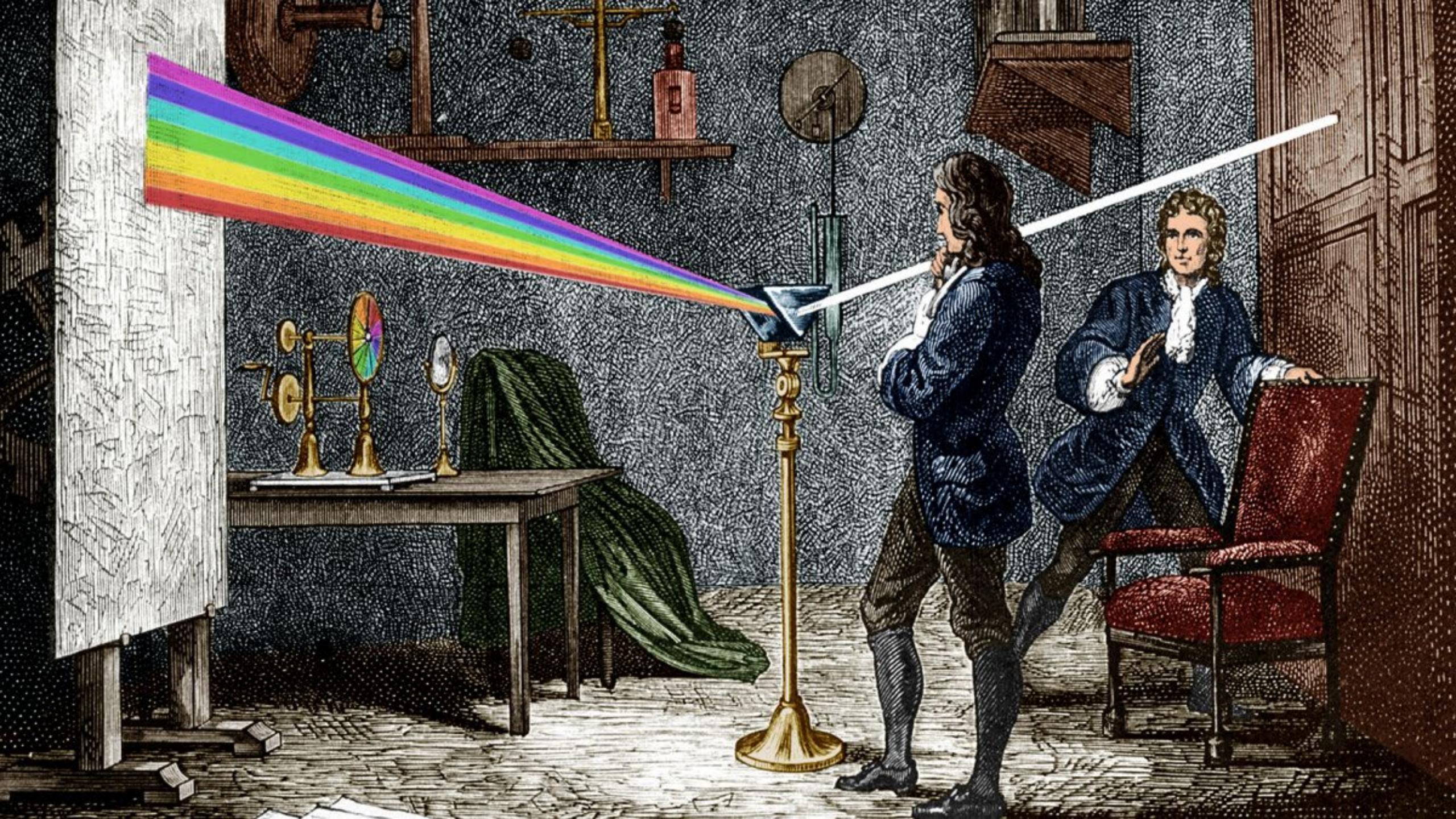
An arrow points from the text "Find a good image formation" to the Φ term in the equation.

“Find a hyperspectral image $\mathbf{h}$ that satisfies the image formation”

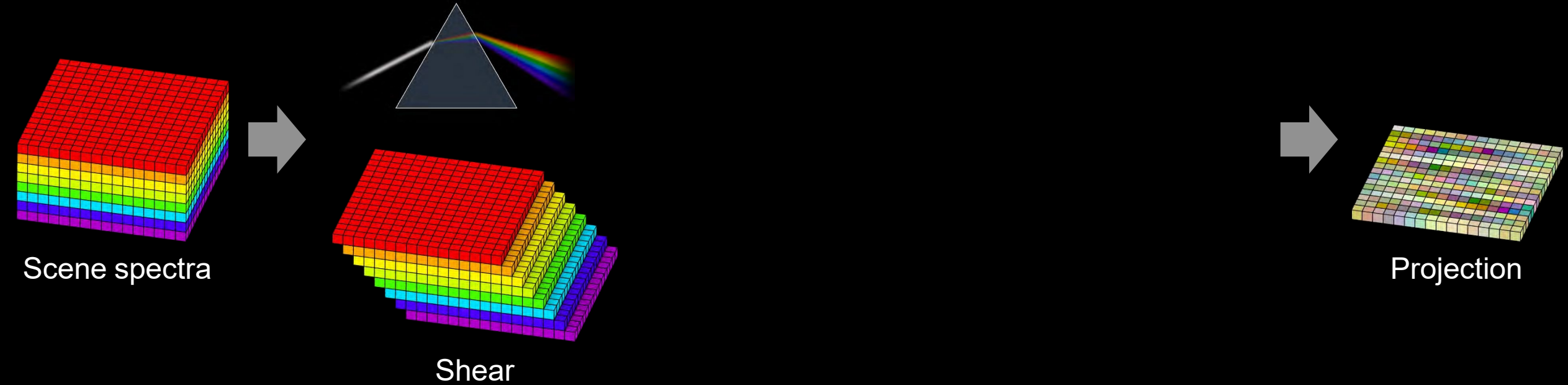
equations $\ll$ # unknowns

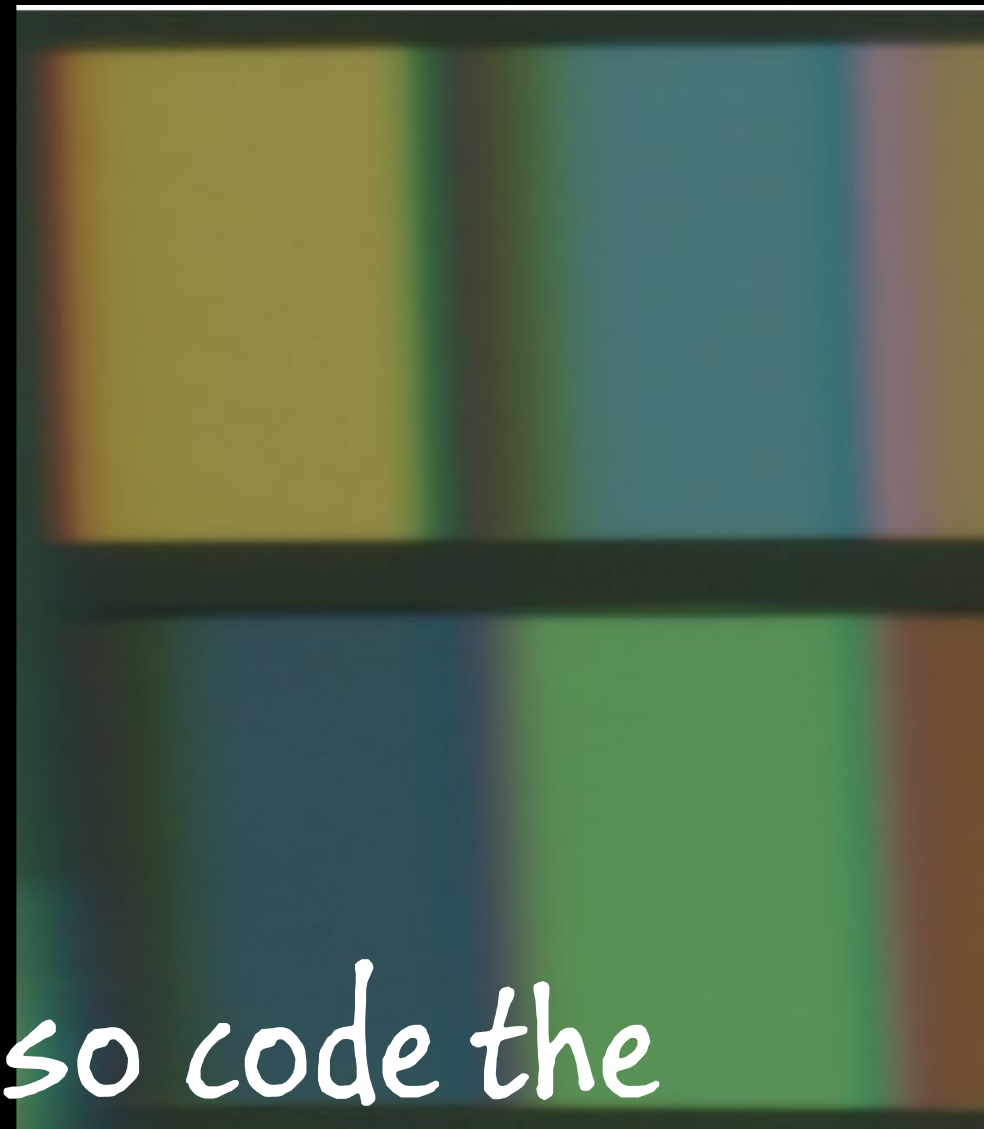


underdetermined system



Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



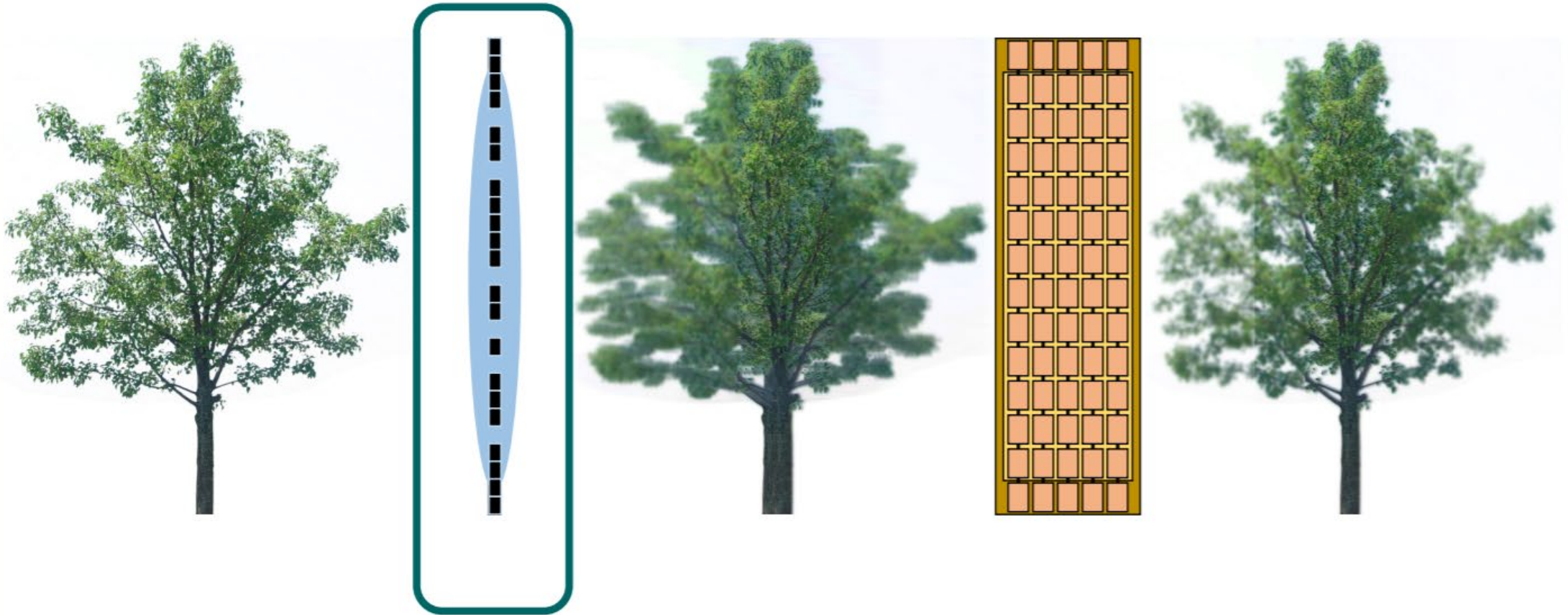


But... what if we also code the
aperture?

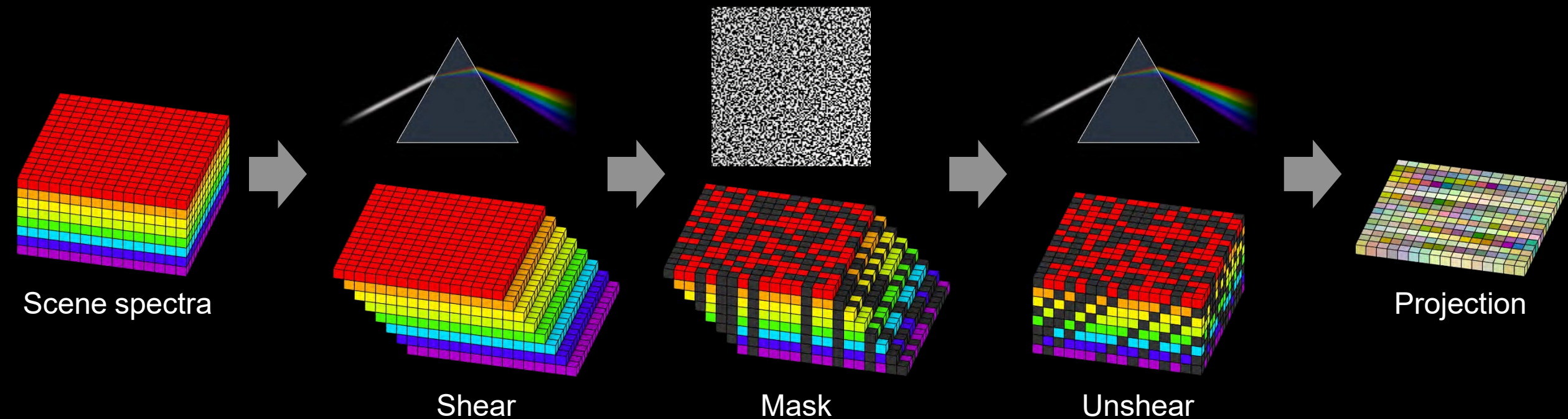
Source: Baek et al. 2017

Remember...

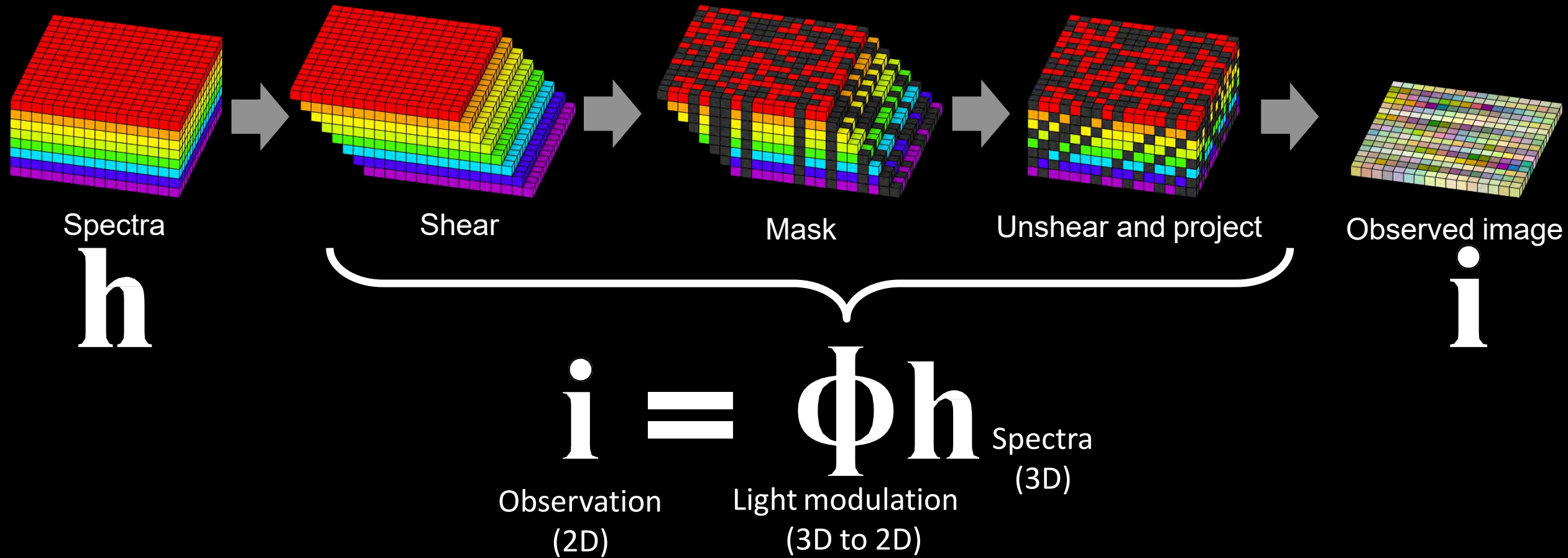
Last class: Coded apertures for defocus deblurring



Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging

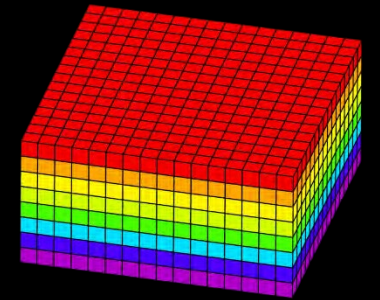
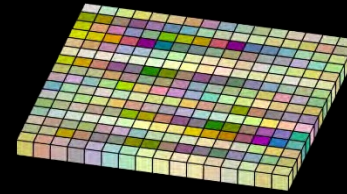


Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging

$$\min_{\mathbf{h}} \left\| \mathbf{i} - \Phi \mathbf{h} \right\|_2^2$$

“Find a hyperspectral image $\mathbf{h}$
that satisfies the image formation”

equations $\ll$ # unknowns



underdetermined system

Optimization-Based Hyperspectral Imaging

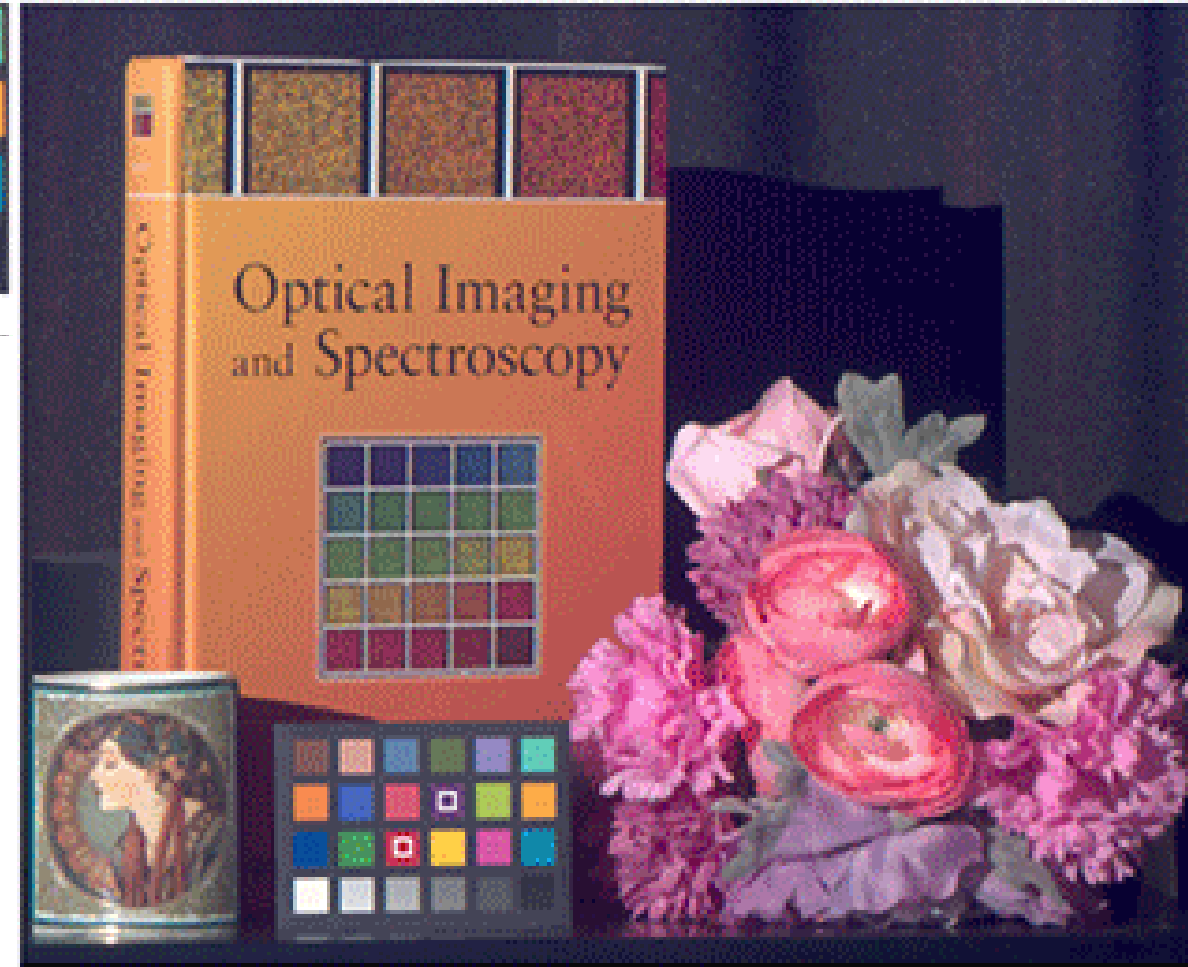
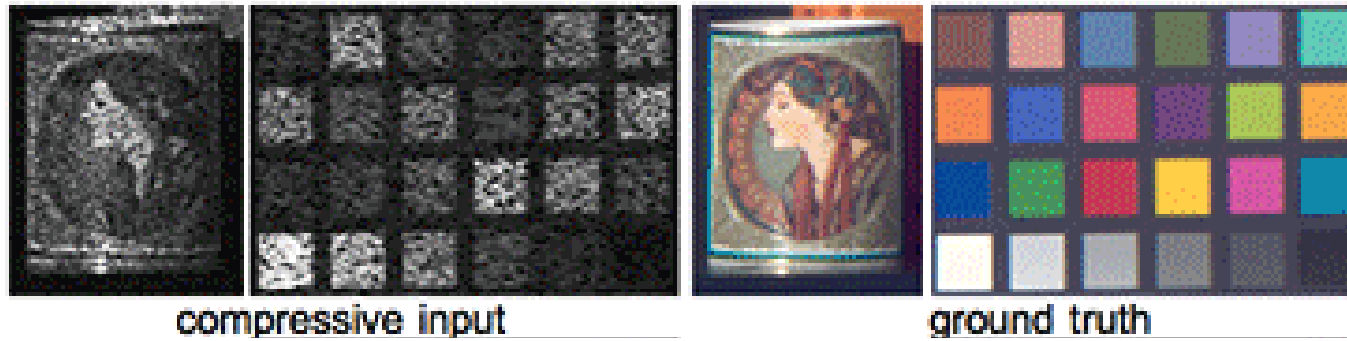
- TV-L1 is very common in computational photography

$$\min_{\mathbf{h}} \left\| \mathbf{i} - \Phi \mathbf{h} \right\|_2^2 + \left\| \mathbf{h} \right\|_1$$

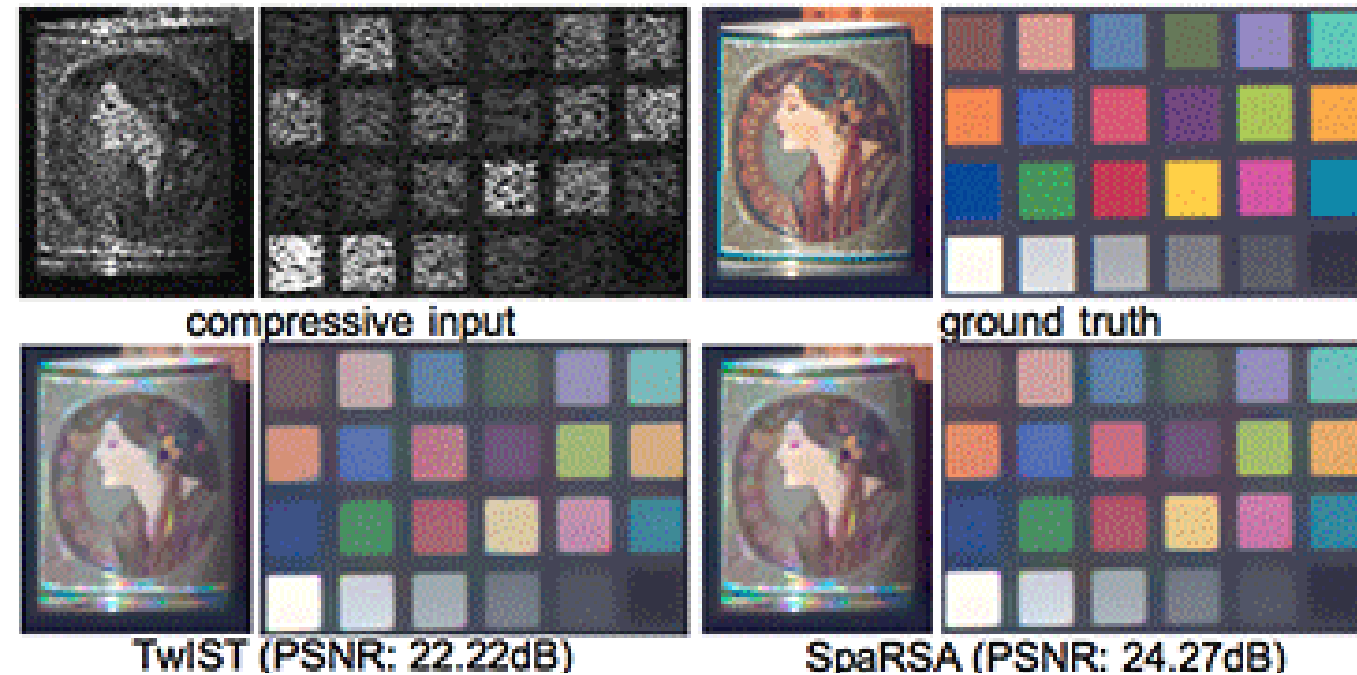
TwIST [Bioucas-Dias and Figueiredo 2007]

SpaRSA [Wright et al. 2009]

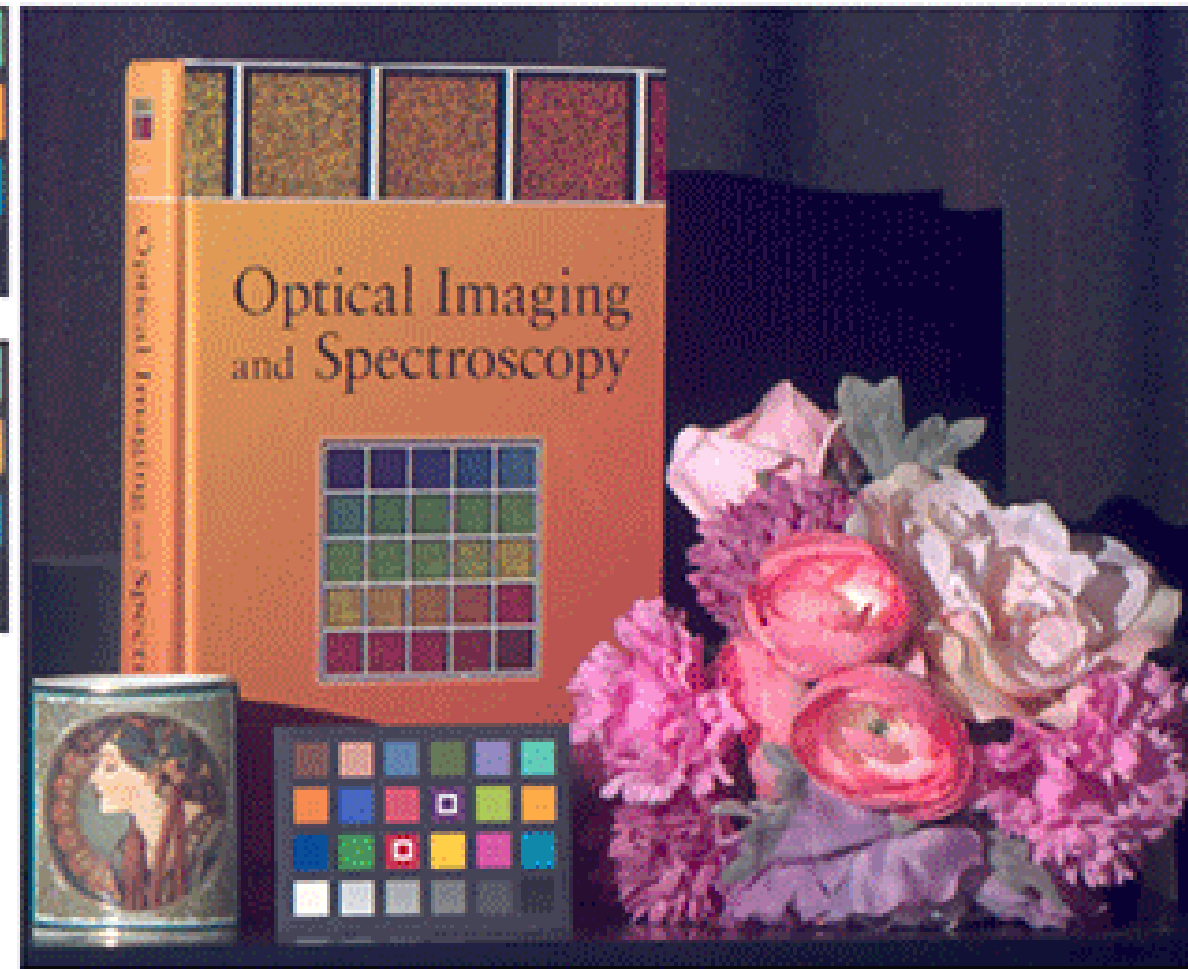
Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



Can we do better?



Can we do better than Total Variation?

Remember...

Compressive Sampling



$N/2$ samples = N pixels

Compressed Hyperspectral Imaging

- Use an overcomplete dictionary and a sparse code to represent a data

$$\mathbf{h} = \mathbf{D}\boldsymbol{\alpha}$$

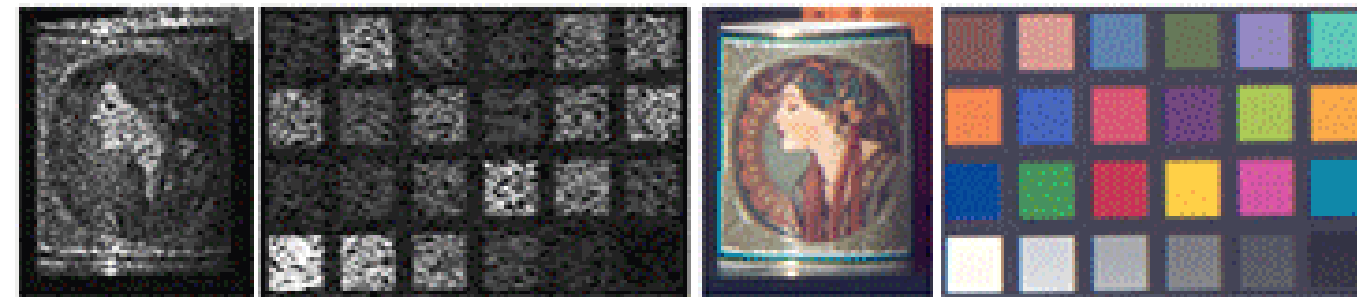
D: a dictionary
 $\boldsymbol{\alpha}$: a sparse code

For all overlapping image patches

$$\min_{\boldsymbol{\alpha}} \left\| \mathbf{i} - \Phi \mathbf{D} \boldsymbol{\alpha} \right\|_2^2 + \left\| \boldsymbol{\alpha} \right\|_1$$

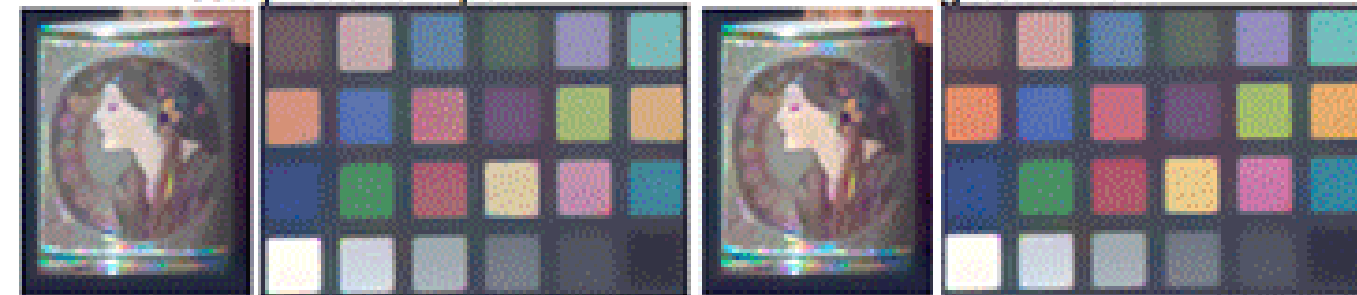
[Lin et al. 2014]

Reconstruction-Based Hyperspectral Imaging



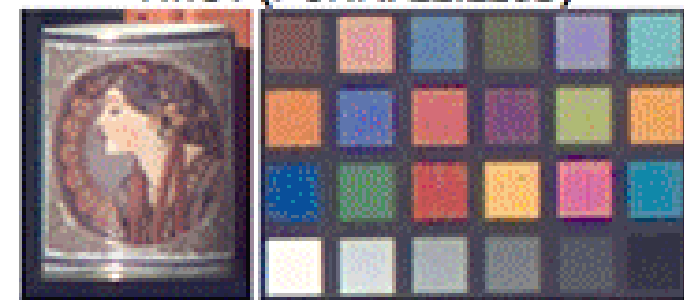
compressive input

ground truth

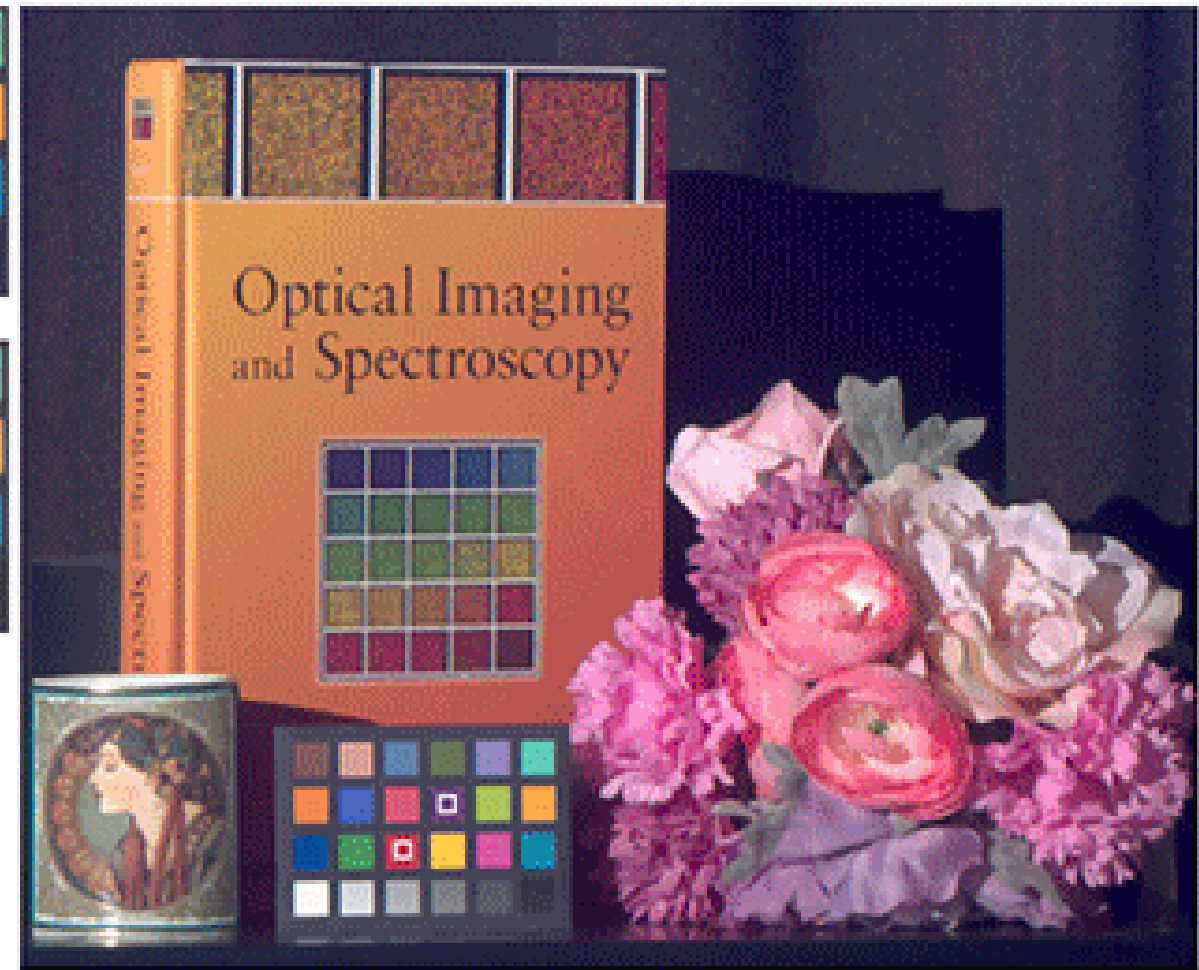


TwIST (PSNR: 22.22dB)

SpaRSA (PSNR: 24.27dB)



sparse coding (PSNR: 28.36dB)



Hyperspectral Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

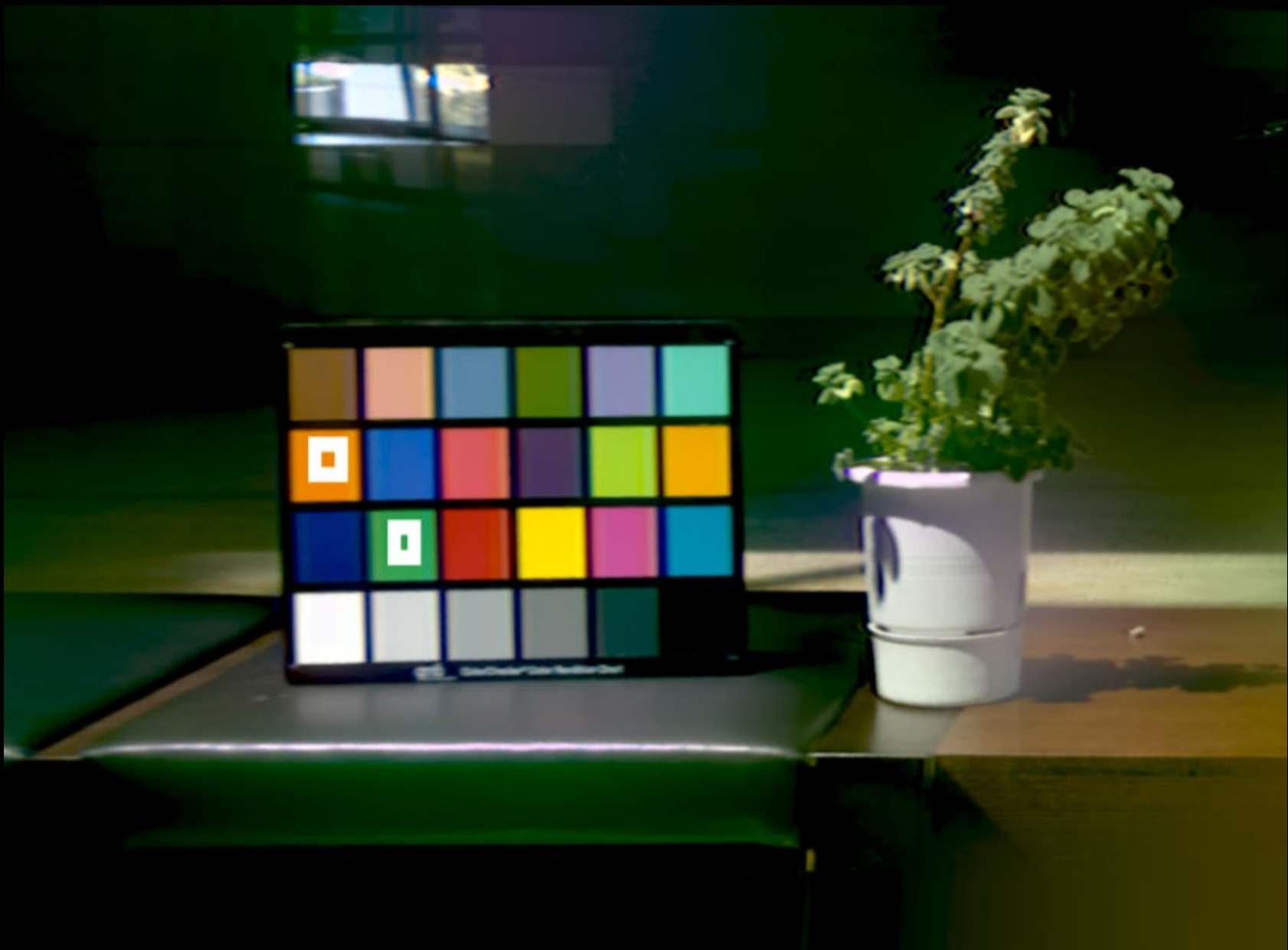
- **Spectral scanning** – *Naïve approach*
 - *Static scenes only, low spatial resolution*
- **Reconstruction-Based** – *The Comp. Img. Approach*
 - *TV-based optimization, CS, Deep Learning...*
 - *Bulky hardware, still expensive*

Questions?

Hyperspectral Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

- **Spectral scanning** – *Naïve approach*
 - *Static scenes only, low spatial resolution*
- **Reconstruction-Based** – *The Comp. Img. Approach*
 - *TV-based optimization, CS, Deep Learning...*
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Hyperspectral Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

- **Spectral scanning** – *Naïve approach*
 - *Static scenes only, low spatial resolution*
- **Reconstruction-Based** – *The Comp. Img. Approach*
 - *TV-based optimization, CS, Deep Learning...*
 - *Bulky hardware, still expensive*
- **High-Rez Dispersion-Based Imaging**
 - *Exploiting sparsity on the gradient domain!*
 - *See [Baek et al. 2017]*

Recap

- **Hyperspectral imaging**

- **What:** Capturing more spectral samples, potentially outside the visible spectrum, than conventional cameras/the human eye.
- **Why:** Many applications in CV and Graphics, including material recognition, remote sensing, relighting...
- **How:** From naïve spectral scanning to compressed sensing & deep learning.

- **What comes next?**

Questions?



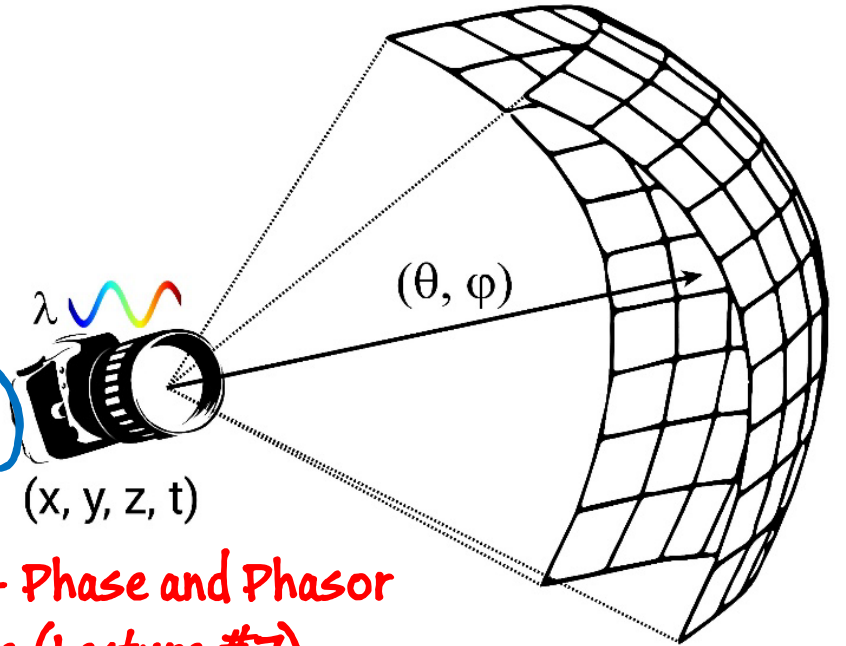
James Clerk Maxwell (1831-1979)

Extended Plenoptic imaging

→ Hyperspectral imaging (Lecture #8)

$$P = P(\theta, \phi, \lambda, t, x, y, z, \{s, p\})$$

→ Polarization - Phase and Phasor Amplitude (Lecture #7)



- Why are these interesting/important?
- How can we capture them back with our camera.

POLARIZATION IMAGING

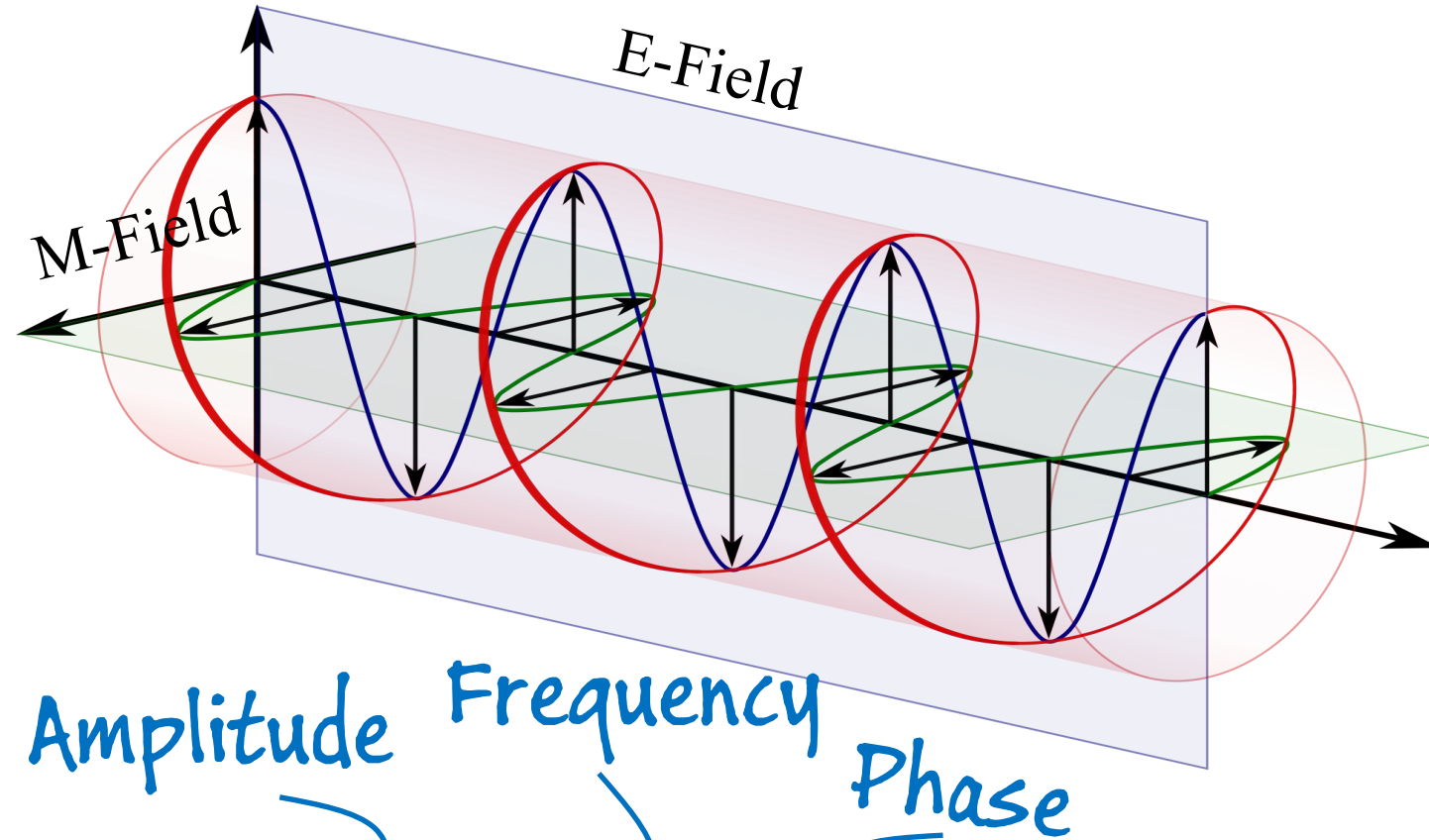
OR ITS Fancier NAME:

“STOKES IMAGING”

Polarization Imaging

- **What** is it?
- **Why** is it important? (a.k.a. applications)
- **How** do we capture it?

Light as an electromagnetic wave

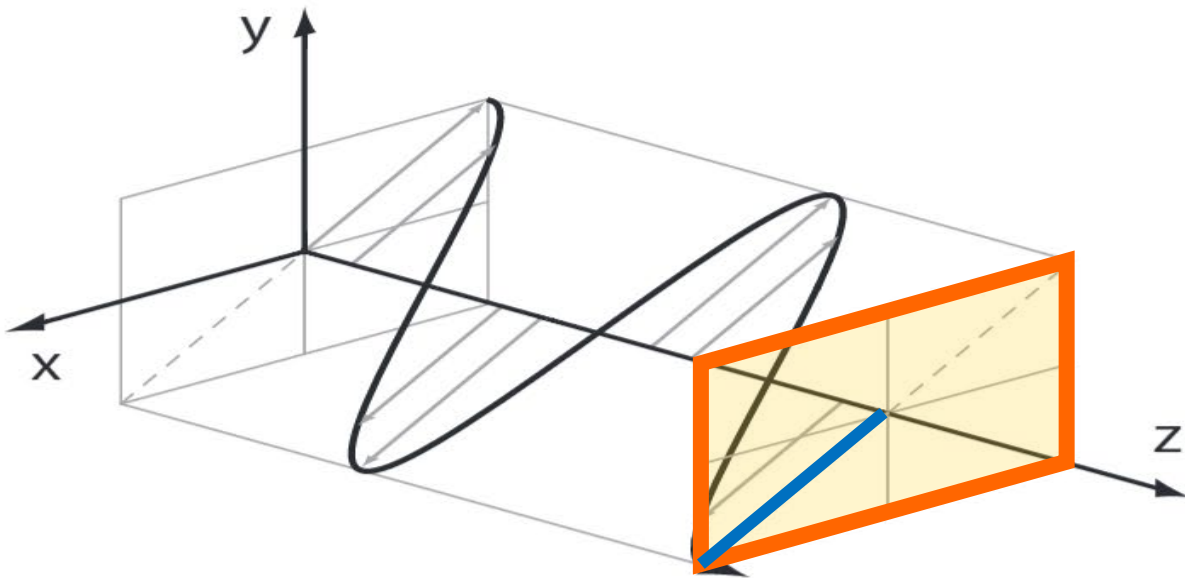


Amplitude Frequency Phase

$$E_{\mathbf{xy}}(r) = \langle I_s \sin(\omega r + \phi_s), I_p \sin(\omega r + \phi_p) \rangle$$

Polarization

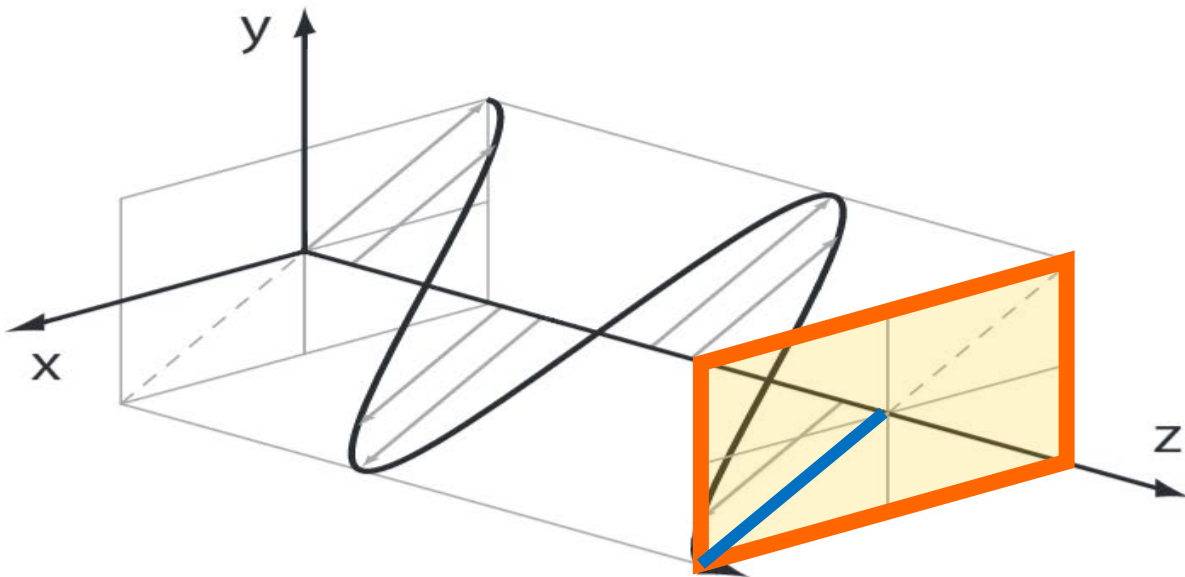
- The amplitude of both phasors and their relative phase, affect the *shape* of the wavefront – its polarization.



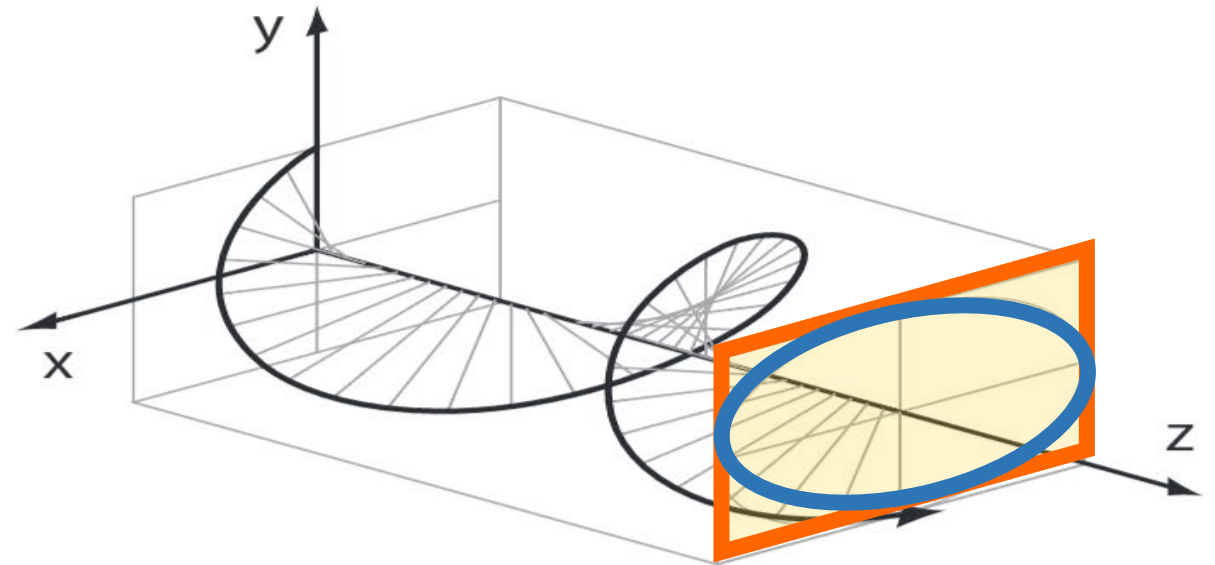
Linear polarization

Polarization

- The amplitude of both phasors and their relative phase, affect the *shape* of the wavefront – its polarization.

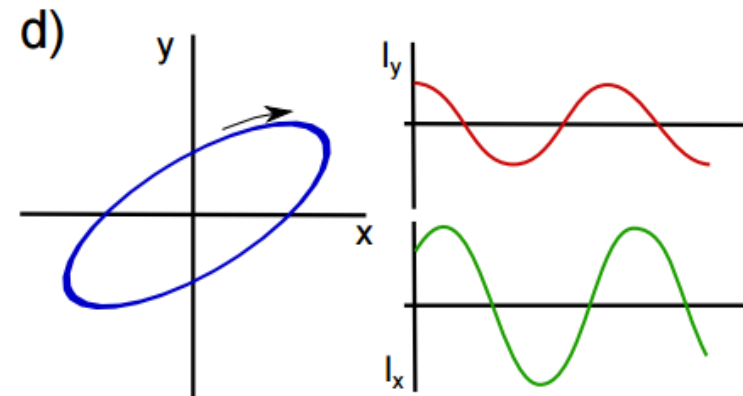
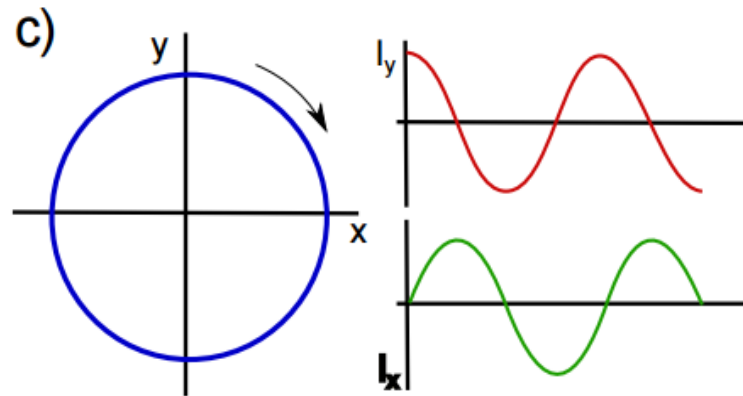
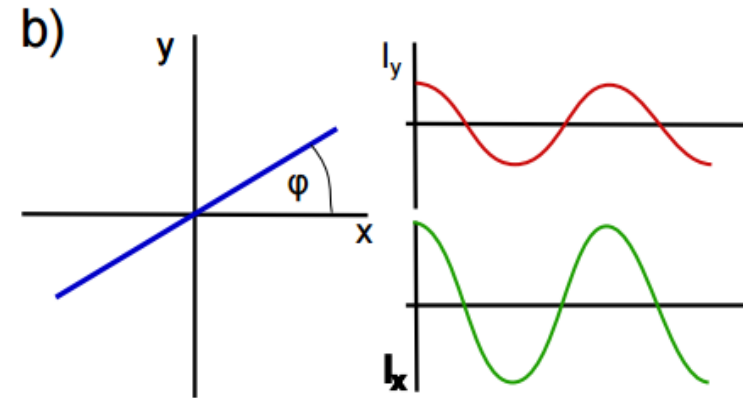
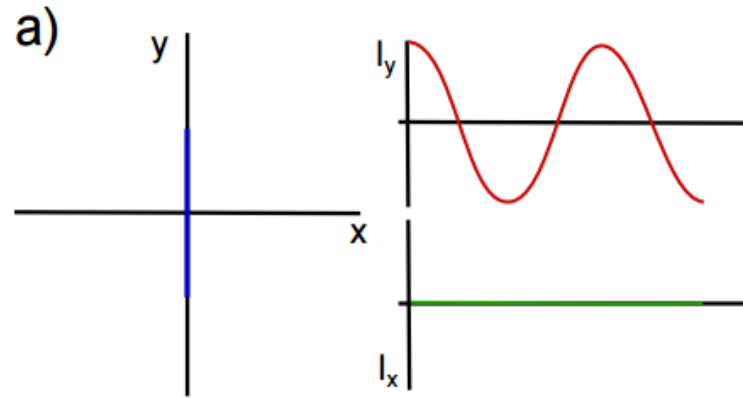


Linear polarization



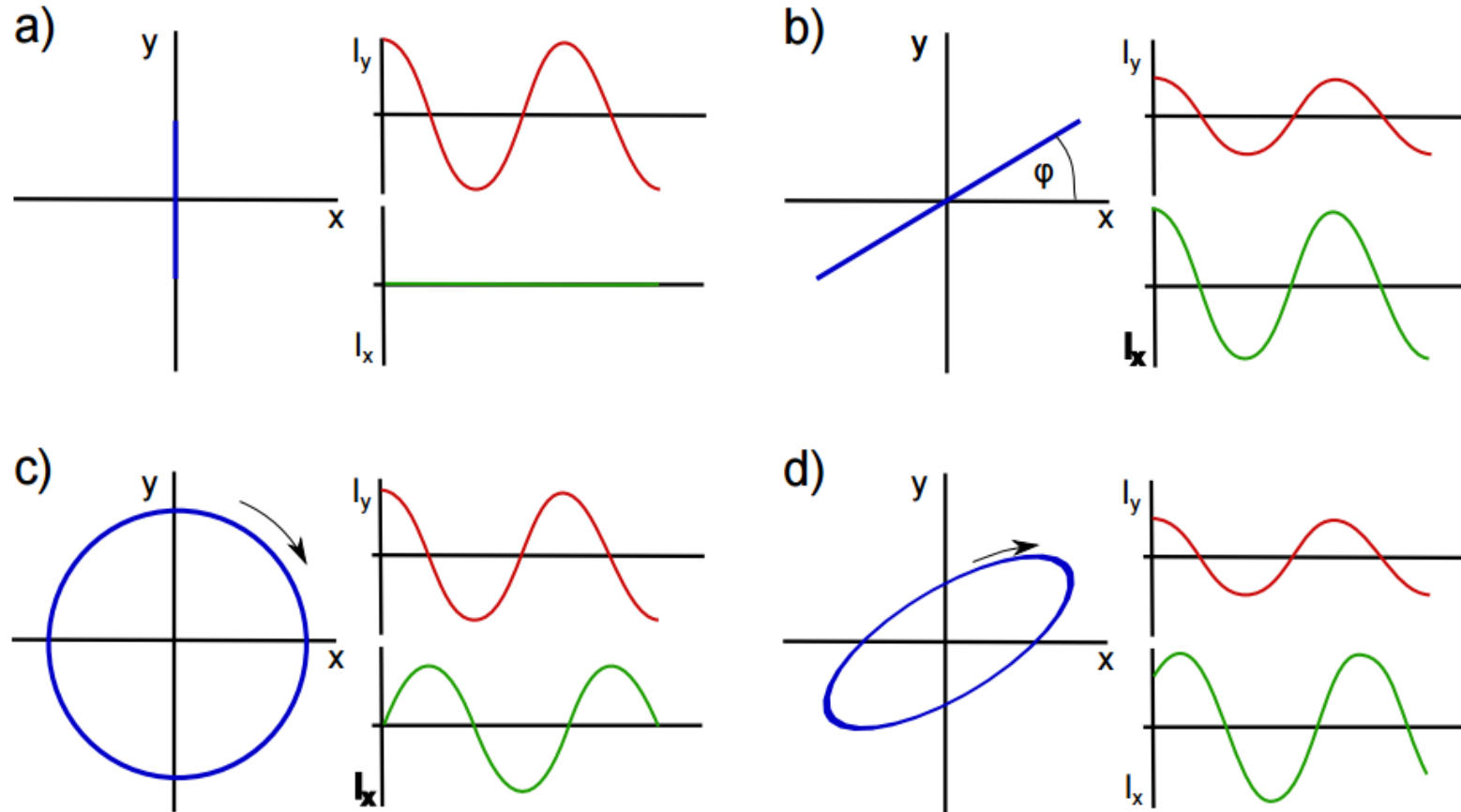
Elliptical polarization

Polarization – *A small quiz*



Polarization – A small quiz

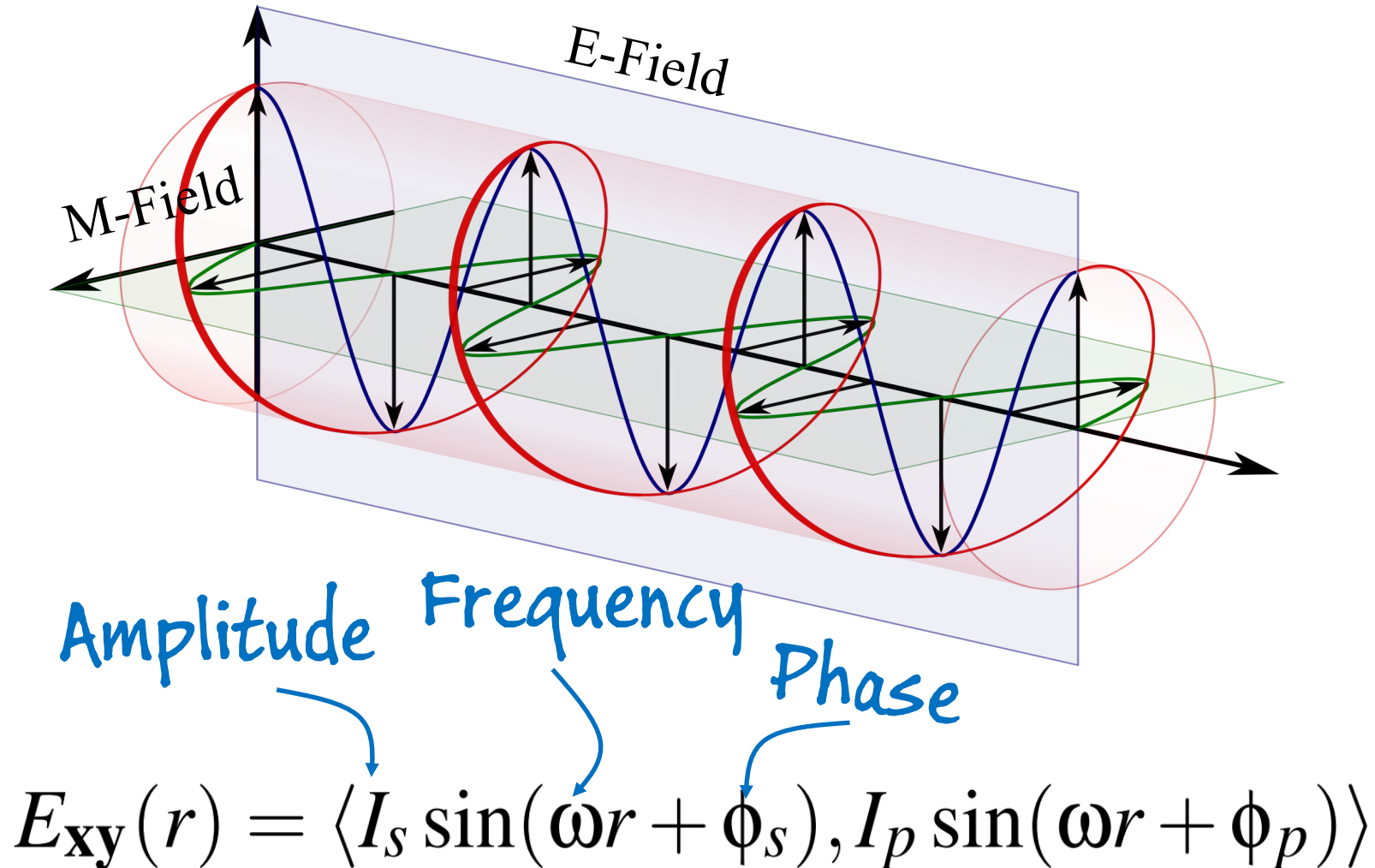
Linear polarization – In phase



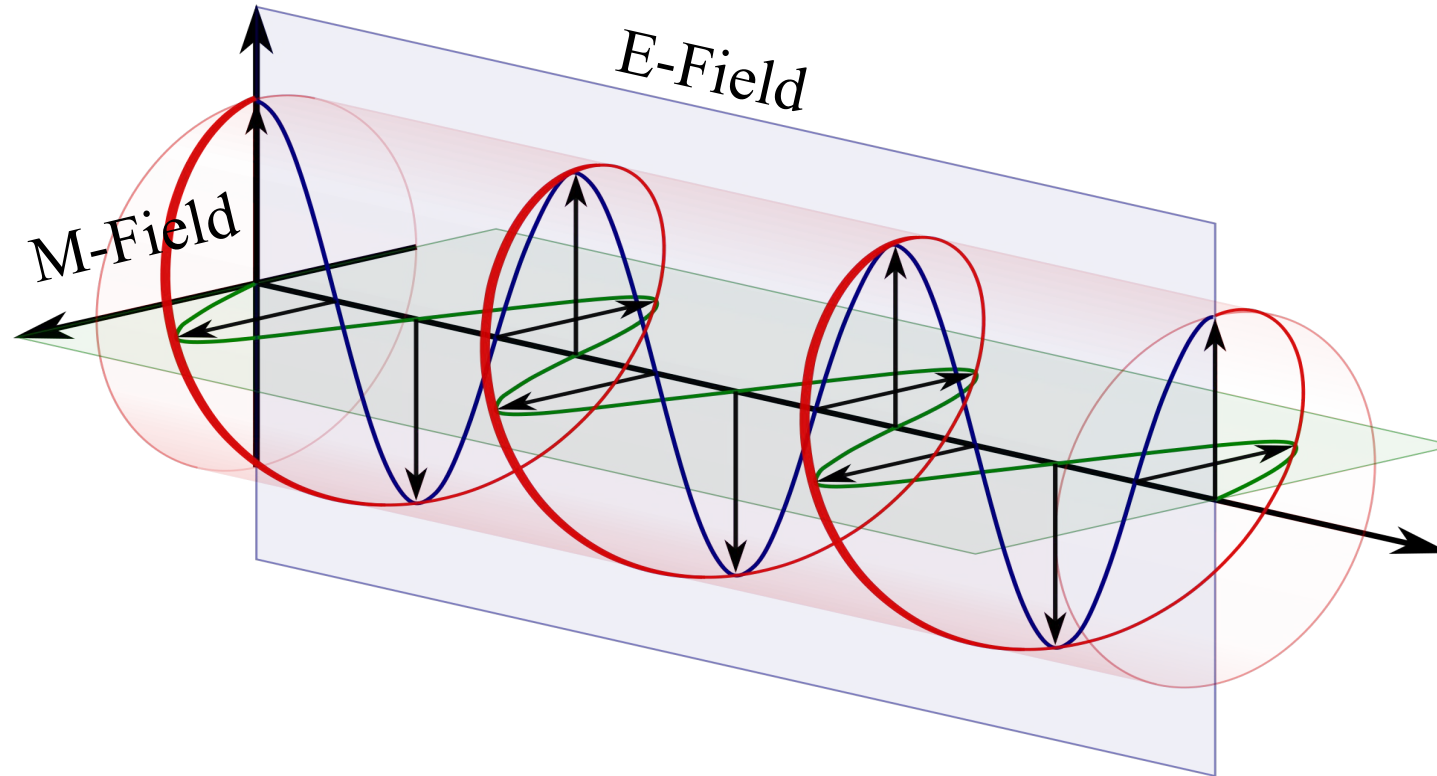
Elliptical polarization – Off-phase

If $I_s = I_p$ and $\phi_s - \phi_p = 90^\circ$ then circular polarization

Light as an electromagnetic wave



Light as an electromagnetic wave



But wait, natural light is not completely polarized

We need another form of representing pol/unpolarized light!

Stokes Vectors



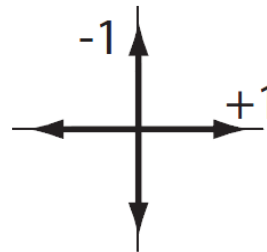
Intensity

$$S_0$$

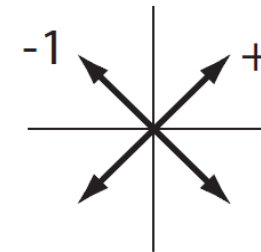


**Linear
Polarization**

$$S_1$$

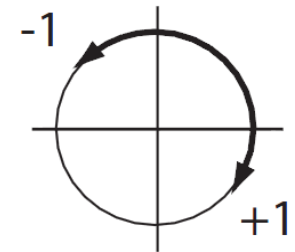


$$S_2$$



**Circular
Polarization**

$$S_3$$



G. G. Stokes, (1852). "On the composition and resolution of streams of polarized light from different sources". Transactions of the Cambridge Philosophical Society

Stokes Vectors



Sir George Stokes (1819-1903)

Representing E as a complex number
(a.k.a. Jones vector):

$$E_p = I_p e^{i\phi_p}$$

$$E_s = I_s e^{i\phi_s}$$

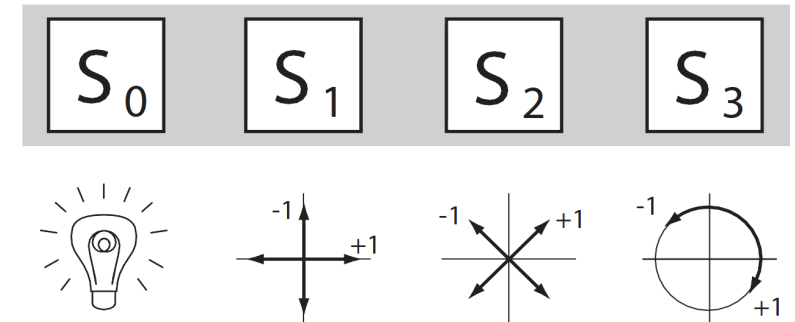
We compute the **Stokes vector** as:

$$S_0 = |I_p|^2 + |I_s|^2$$

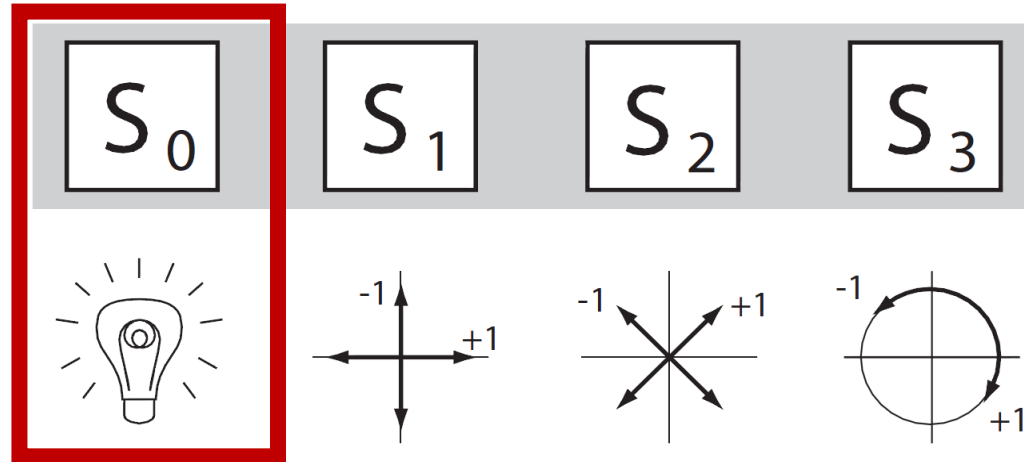
$$S_1 = |I_p|^2 - |I_s|^2$$

$$S_2 = \text{Re}(E_p E_s^*)$$

$$S_3 = \text{Im}(E_p E_s^*)$$



Stokes Vectors



Remember:
Unfortunately, a camera
only captures intensity

Polarization (Stokes) imaging

- Cameras (and eyes) do not capture polarization, just intensity
- ... so the info about phase and phasor intensity is lost.
- **Polarization imaging** tries to:
 - a) Recover (at least) the polarization state of light
 - b) Not all info of the EM-field, but at least its macroscopic behaviour

Sources of polarization

- Obviously, beyond polarizing filters
- BTW, have you tried to see your phone with polarizer sunglasses?
- Reflection and Transmission in **Dielectrics**.
 - Check out the Fresnel equations
 - Metals/Conductors are weakly polarizers







Sources of polarization

- Obviously, beyond polarizing filters
- BTW, have you tried to see your phone with polarizer sunglasses?
- Reflection and Transmission in **Dielectrics**.
 - Check out the Fresnel equations
 - Metals/Conductors are weakly polarizers
- **Scattering** in media
 - Specially Rayleigh, but also larger particles





Why should we care about polarization?

- **Brainstorming:** Where and why would we like to have pol-info?

Removal of specular reflections



Removal of specular reflections



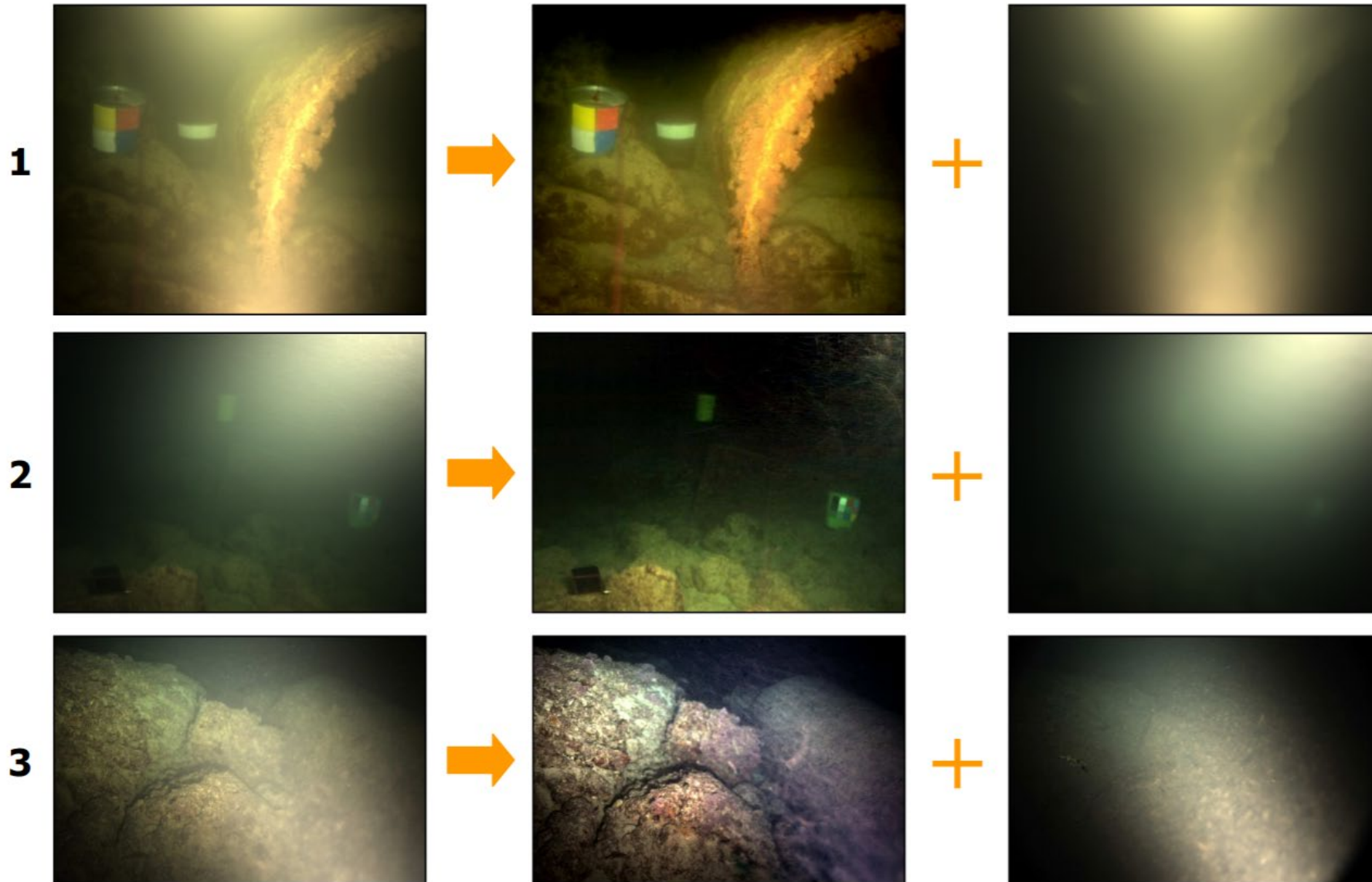
Removal of specular reflections

<https://youtu.be/yhjKO1a99OQ?t=56>

Specular-Diffuse separation



Vision through media - *Dehazing*





Why should we care about polarization?

- **Brainstorming:** Where and why would we like to have pol-info?
- Remove specular reflections
- Diffuse/specular decomposition
- Vision through media
- Material recognition
- ...

Quick Quiz

- What is the best technique for obtaining local detail in computer vision?
 - a) A time-of-flight camera (e.g. lidar) *Transient Imaging (Lecture #9)*
 - b) Shape-from-specular
 - c) Multiview-Stereo
 - d) Coded illumination *Computational illumination (Lecture #7)*

Why should we care about polarization?

- **Brainstorming:** Where and why would we like to have pol-info?
- Remove specular reflections
- Diffuse/specular decomposition
 - With applications on shape-from-specular
- Vision through media
- Material recognition
- ...

Questions?

Polarization Imaging

- What is it?
- Why is it important? (a.k.a. applications)
- **How** do we capture it?

Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

- What we need:

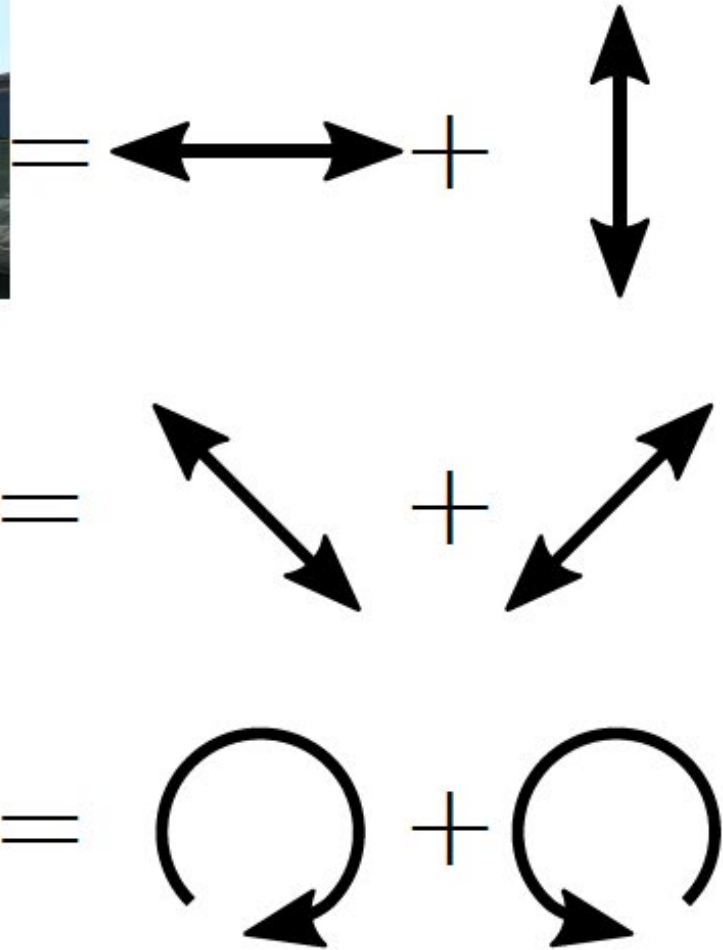


A conventional Camera

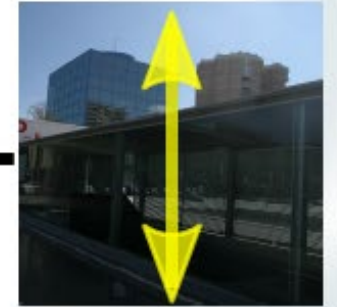
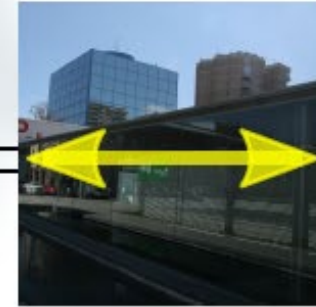


Polarizing Filters

Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*



Q



U



V



Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

$$\begin{aligned}
 I &= \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-right to bottom-left)} \end{array} + \right) / 2 \\
 Q &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-right to bottom-left)} \end{array} \\
 U &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-right to bottom-left)} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \end{array} \\
 V &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-right to bottom-left)} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \end{array} \\
 \end{aligned}$$

I is the total intensity. Q , U , and V are the Stokes parameters. The images show a scene with a building and a bench, with yellow arrows indicating the polarization direction for each component. The V parameter's second image is a red square with a yellow circular arrow, indicating circular polarization.

Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

$$\begin{aligned}
 I &= \left(\begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (bottom-left to top-right)} \end{array} + \right) / 2 \\
 Q &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (bottom-left to top-right)} \end{array} \\
 U &= \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 3: Diagonal yellow double arrow (top-left to bottom-right)} \\ \text{Image 4: Diagonal yellow double arrow (bottom-left to top-right)} \end{array} - \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 1: Horizontal yellow double arrow} \\ \text{Image 2: Vertical yellow double arrow} \end{array} \\
 V &= 2 \begin{array}{c} \text{Image 5: Circular yellow arrow (clockwise)} \end{array} - I
 \end{aligned}$$

I is the total intensity image. Q and U are the linear polarization images. V is the circular polarization image. The images show a scene with a building and a railing, with yellow arrows indicating the polarization direction for each component.

Polarization Imaging - *How do we capture it?*

- **Stokes scanning** – *Naïve approach*
 - *Static scenes only, 5 shots (4 linear, 1 circular pol)*
- **Interferometry-based approaches**
 - *Single-shot, but super-complex setups...*
- **Some Bayer-like per-pixel filters**
 - *Expensive, only linear polarization, demosaicing hell*

Recap

- **Polarization/Stokes imaging**
 - **What:** Capturing information beyond (spectral) radiance, including phasor information of the carrier, encoded in its *polarization* state.
 - **Why:** Most surfaces and media polarize / depolarize light:
 - Lots of info about surfaces (optical properties) and their shape (shape from specular)
 - Removal components (specular, scattering) for improved imaging!
 - **How:** Capture the Stokes vectors, multiple measurements using linear/circular polarizing filters.

In summary – *Take home messages*

- The choice of our imaging systems is based on the **human's eye**, which is amazing, but far from perfect
- In general, we only care about **radiance** (not even spectral), neglecting the EM nature of light
 - Maybe that's why the particle hypothesis prevailed for 15 centuries...
- **Hyperspectral** and **polarization** information are very useful for scene understanding and CV. Let's use them!
 - In the end, some of the most sophisticated eyes in nature exploit them heavily.



Questions?



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